

THREE COLOURS FOR THE PLANE OVER A NUMBER FIELD

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ABSTRACT. For a field F of characteristic 0 let $\chi(F^2)$ be the chromatic number of the graph on F^2 that joins x and y when $(x_1 - y_1)^2 + (x_2 - y_2)^2 = 1$. We prove that for every number field F , $\chi(F^2) \leq 3$ if and only if some prime of F above 2 ramifies in $F(i)$ or some prime of F above 3 has residue degree 1. The “if” part is classical (colourings through a residue field); the “only if” part extends to all number fields our earlier result that $\chi(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{d})^2) \geq 4$ for $d \equiv 11 \pmod{12}$. It answers, for three colours, the question whether the chromatic number of the plane over a number field is decided by a single completion, and it classifies the finite extensions K of $\mathbb{Q}_p$: $\chi(K^2)$ is 2, 3 or at least 4 according to explicit local conditions. We also give an elementary family (every real field containing $\sqrt{a}$ and $\sqrt{b}$ with $a \equiv 2 \pmod{3}$ and $b \equiv 7 \pmod{8}$ needs four colours), new examples such as $\chi(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{7})^2) = 4$, and, as far as we know, the first non-integral value of the circular chromatic number of the plane over a number field: $\chi_c(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{11})^2) = \chi_c(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{35})^2) = 7/2$ (and $\chi_c(\mathbb{Q}_7^2) = 7/2$), although these planes have chromatic number 4. Locally constant colourings of one completion give no upper bound on χ_c below 4 other than 2, 3 and $7/2$. We show that these are the only values below 4: for every number field F , $\chi_c(F^2)$ is 2, 3, $7/2$ or at least 4, and it is $7/2$ exactly when $\chi(F^2) \geq 4$ and some prime of F above 7 has residue degree 1. So below 4 the circular chromatic number is also decided by a single completion. This proof has one computer-assisted step, an exact finite computation along the rational rotations whose denominators divide 325; without it we show that $\chi_c(F^2) \geq 56/17$ whenever $\chi(F^2) \geq 4$.

1. INTRODUCTION

Let F be a field of characteristic 0. The *plane over F* is the graph on F^2 in which x and y are adjacent when $(x_1 - y_1)^2 + (x_2 - y_2)^2 = 1$, and $\chi(F^2)$ is its chromatic number. For $F = \mathbb{R}$ this is the Hadwiger–Nelson problem, and $5 \leq \chi(\mathbb{R}^2) \leq 7$ [5]. Over number fields the question goes back to Woodall ($\chi(\mathbb{Q}^2) = 2$ [22]) and was studied by Johnson [15], Fischer [7], Benda and Perles [1], Moorhouse [19] and Madore [17]. All upper bounds below 7 known to us come from a colouring that is locally constant at one completion F_v : reduction modulo a power of a prime. Writing $L = F(i)$, the unit vectors of F^2 are the elements of norm one of L , and at a place where $x^2 + y^2$ is anisotropic they reduce into a finite group of roots of unity of the residue field. Two such reductions give colourings with at most three colours:

- (a) at a prime of F above 2 that ramifies in $F(i)$, every unit vector is $\equiv 1$ modulo the maximal ideal, which gives a 2-colouring (Johnson; Fischer [7, Thm. 8]; Moorhouse [19]; [18, Theorem A’]);
- (b) at a prime of F above 3 of residue degree 1, the unit vectors reduce into $\mu_4 \subset \mathbb{F}_9$, and $a + bi \mapsto a + b$ gives a 3-colouring (Madore [17, Cor. 3.4]; for real quadratic fields Moorhouse [19, Lemma 8.2 and Cor. 8.3] and Fischer [7, Thm. 9]).

In [13] we proved that (a) is also necessary for $\chi(F^2) = 2$. Here we prove the same at three colours.

Theorem B. *Let F be a number field. Then $\chi(F^2) \leq 3$ if and only if (a) or (b) holds; and $\chi(F^2) \leq 2$ if and only if (a) holds.*

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These results were obtained with the assistance of an AI system (Claude, by Anthropic), which found the proofs, wrote them and the programs that check them, and helped to draft this note. Separate AI agents refereed the proofs, with their own programs. No mathematician has checked the note yet. The author is not a professional mathematician and submits it for independent verification.

For real quadratic fields $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{d})$, d squarefree, (a) holds iff $d \not\equiv 3 \pmod{4}$ and (b) iff $d \not\equiv 2 \pmod{3}$, so Theorem B contains the main result of [11] (Theorem 1 and Corollary 2 there): $\chi(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{d})^2) \geq 4$ iff $d \equiv 11 \pmod{12}$. Whether (a) or (b) holds depends only on $F \otimes \mathbb{Q}_2$ and $F \otimes \mathbb{Q}_3$, and is computed from a defining polynomial (the relative discriminant of $F(i)/F$, and the residue degrees above 3). By the theorem of de Bruijn and Erdős [4], $\chi(F^2) \geq 4$ if and only if some finite unit-distance graph in F^2 needs four colours, and Theorem B says that this happens unless one of the completions of F has a locally constant 3-colouring: a local-global principle for three colours. The same proof decides the local fields (Corollary 3): for a finite extension K of $\mathbb{Q}_p$, $\chi(K^2) = 2$ if $p = 2$ and $K(i)/K$ is ramified, $\chi(K^2) = 3$ if $p = 3$ and K has residue degree 1, and $\chi(K^2) \geq 4$ otherwise; for instance the plane over the unramified cubic extension of $\mathbb{Q}_3$ needs at least four colours, although $x^2 + y^2$ is anisotropic there, as over $\mathbb{Q}_3$.

Two families of fields were known to need four colours: those containing $\sqrt{d}$ with $d \equiv 11 \pmod{12}$ [11], and those containing $\sqrt{3}$ and $\sqrt{q}$ with $q \equiv 2 \pmod{3}$, by chains of unit rhombi ([9], `notes/local_colourings.md`, Section 11, Theorem 5). Theorem B adds, for example, $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{7})$, $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{31})$ and $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{55})$, which contain no unit triangle and whose quadratic subfields all have $\chi \leq 3$, and $\mathbb{Q}(2 \cos \frac{2\pi}{7}, \sqrt{7})$, of degree 6, where 3 has residue degree 3. For many fields an explicit proof is short (Proposition 2), and for $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{7})$ we give a certificate checked by computer that does not depend on the general argument.

Theorem C. $\chi_c(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{11})^2) = \chi_c(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{35})^2) = \chi_c(\mathbb{Q}_7^2) = 7/2$, while the three chromatic numbers are 4. Moreover no plane over a number field has circular chromatic number strictly between 2 and 3.

Theorem D. Let F be a number field with $\chi(F^2) \geq 4$. Then $\chi_c(F^2) \geq 56/17 \approx 3.294$.

Theorem E. Let F be a number field with $\chi(F^2) \geq 4$. Then $\chi_c(F^2) \geq 7/2$. So $\chi_c(F^2) \in \{2, 3\} \cup [7/2, \infty]$ for every number field F , and the value $7/2$ is attained.

Theorem F. Let F be a number field, and consider the condition

(7) some prime of F above 7 has residue degree 1.

Then $\chi_c(F^2) = 2$ if (a) holds; $\chi_c(F^2) = 3$ if (b) holds and (a) fails; $\chi_c(F^2) = 7/2$ if (7) holds and (a), (b) fail; and $\chi_c(F^2) \geq 4$ if (a), (b) and (7) all fail.

Theorems E and F each rest on one computer-assisted step, an exact finite computation with certificates that are checked by a program written separately from the one that produced them, and confirmed by two further methods (Propositions 8 and 9); the rest of their proofs is by hand. Theorem D, which Theorem E supersedes, is proved entirely by hand. So below 4 the circular chromatic number of the plane over a number field takes only the values 2, 3 and $7/2$, each given by a locally constant colouring of one completion: a circular local-global principle below 4 that extends Theorem B. For a real quadratic field $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{d})$ with $d \equiv 11 \pmod{12}$ squarefree, (a) and (b) fail, so $\chi_c = 7/2$ if $(d/7) \neq -1$ and $\chi_c \geq 4$ otherwise: $\chi_c(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{23})^2) = \chi_c(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{71})^2) = 7/2$, $\chi_c(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{59})^2) = 4$ and $\chi_c(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{47})^2) \geq 4$.

The tools are those of [11]: a characterisation of 3-colourings of Cayley graphs of abelian groups by characters (Theorem W^+ , Section 2), and the exact shape of the characters along the rational rotations whose denominators are powers of 5. These rotations act as a probe: along them, a character that keeps every unit vector in $[1/3, 2/3]$ is, up to a bounded error, either a 2-adic “half” character or a 3-adic character of level one, and a compactness argument turns this into the dichotomy between the places above 2 and those above 3. For Theorem D we show that the probe keeps this shape, with a small error also for type q, when $[1/3, 2/3]$ is replaced by $[\theta, 1 - \theta]$ with $\theta > 17/56$ (Proposition 7). This probe cannot pass $10/3$: for $\theta \leq 3/10$ it has 5-adic characters. For Theorems E and F we add one rational rotation with another prime, $\sigma = (5 + 12i)/13$. Along the rotations $i^a \rho^j \sigma^l$ a finite computation modulo 65 shows that the probe keeps the shape c or q for $\theta > 2/7$, and one modulo 325 that for $\theta > 1/4$ it has only these two shapes and a third, 7-adic, one; a compactness argument at the places above 2, 3 and 7 then proves the theorems.

Sections 2–5 prove Theorem B; Section 6 draws the consequences (circular colourings below 3, fields split above 2 and 3, local fields); Section 7 gives the explicit family; Section 8 proves Theorem C and shows that the restrictions to F^2 of locally constant colourings of a completion F_v^2 give no upper bound on $\chi_c(F^2)$ below 4 other than 2, 3 and $7/2$ (Corollary 5); Section 9 proves Theorem D and Section 10 Theorems E and F; Section 11 lists the computer checks, and Section 12 asks what happens above 4. The programs and certificates are in [9].

2. PRELIMINARIES

Characters and colourings. For an abelian group Γ and $S = -S \subseteq \Gamma$, $\text{Cay}(\Gamma, S)$ is the graph on Γ in which $x \sim y$ when $y - x \in S$. A *character* of Γ is a homomorphism $\xi : \Gamma \rightarrow \mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$, and $\|t\|$ is the distance from t to the nearest integer. For integers $p \geq 2q \geq 1$, the circular clique $K_{p/q}$ has vertex set $\mathbb{Z}/p$, with $a \sim b$ when $q \leq (b - a \bmod p) \leq p - q$, and the circular chromatic number $\chi_c(G)$ is the infimum of the p/q such that G has a homomorphism to $K_{p/q}$.

Theorem $\mathbf{W}^+$ ([14, Theorem 1]). *Let $p \geq 2q \geq 2$ with $p < 4q$. Then $\text{Cay}(\Gamma, S)$ has a homomorphism to $K_{p/q}$ if and only if some character ξ of Γ satisfies $\xi(s) \in [q/p, 1 - q/p] + \mathbb{Z}$ for every $s \in S$. In particular $\text{Cay}(\Gamma, S)$ is 3-colourable if and only if some character maps S into $[1/3, 2/3] + \mathbb{Z}$.*

The “if” direction is classical (colour x by $\lfloor p\xi(x) \rfloor$); the “only if” direction is the content of [14], where it is also proved in Lean for every abelian group Γ and finite S . We apply it to the groups $\Gamma = \mathbb{Z}U$ spanned by finite sets U of unit vectors, and in Section 8 to finite groups $O_w/\mathfrak{m}^k$.

The plane as a Cayley graph. Let F be a number field with $i \notin F$, and $L = F(i)$. The map $(x, y) \mapsto x + iy$ identifies F^2 with L , and $x^2 + y^2 = z\bar{z}$ for $z = x + iy$, where $z \mapsto \bar{z}$ is the non-trivial automorphism of L/F . So the unit vectors form the group $T = \{z \in L : z\bar{z} = 1\}$, and the plane over F is $\text{Cay}(L, T)$. As a $\mathbb{Q}(i)$ -vector space L has dimension $n = [F : \mathbb{Q}]$, and $\text{Tr} = \text{Tr}_{L/\mathbb{Q}(i)}$ gives a non-degenerate pairing $L \times L \rightarrow \mathbb{Q}(i)$.

The probe. Let $N = 5^k$, $k \geq 1$, let G_N be the set of $\gamma \in \mathbb{Q}(i)$ with $\gamma\bar{\gamma} = 1$ and $N\gamma \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$ (the rational rotations whose denominator divides N), $I = [1/3, 2/3]$, and

$$S_N = \{c \in \mathbb{C} : \text{Re}(\bar{c}\gamma) \in I + \mathbb{Z} \text{ for every } \gamma \in G_N\}.$$

Let $E_c = \frac{1+i}{2} + \mathbb{Z}[i]$, $E_q = \{\frac{\alpha+\beta i}{3} : \alpha, \beta \in \{1, 2\}\} + \mathbb{Z}[i]$, $E = E_c \cup E_q$, and $r = \sqrt{10}/18$. Elements of E_c have *type c*, those of E_q *type q*.

Proposition 1 ([11, Proposition 9]). *Every $c \in S_N$ can be written $c = N\varepsilon + x$, either with $\varepsilon \in E_c$ and $|x| \leq r$, or with $\varepsilon \in E_q$ and $x = 0$.*

Lemma 1 (exact relations; cf. [11, Lemma 10]). *Let $\sigma_j = N\varepsilon_j + x_j \in S_N$ be as in Proposition 1 ($1 \leq j \leq \ell$), and let $\mu_1, \dots, \mu_\ell \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$ satisfy $\sum_j \mu_j \sigma_j = 0$ and $N > 6r \sum_j |\mu_j|$. Then $\sum_j \mu_j \varepsilon_j = 0$.*

Proof. $\sum_j \mu_j N\varepsilon_j = -\sum_j \mu_j x_j$. The left side lies in $\frac{N}{6}\mathbb{Z}[i]$, because $6E \subseteq \mathbb{Z}[i]$, and the nonzero elements of $\frac{N}{6}\mathbb{Z}[i]$ have modulus at least $\frac{N}{6}$; the right side has modulus at most $r \sum_j |\mu_j| < \frac{N}{6}$. So both sides vanish. $\square$

Only two properties of E are used below. Let $\mathbb{F}_9 = \mathbb{Z}[i]/3$ and $A' = \{\pm 1 \pm i\} \subset \mathbb{F}_9$, the set of non-squares of $\mathbb{F}_9$ (equivalently, of the $y \in \mathbb{F}_9$ with $y^4 = -1$). Then

$$(1) \quad \varepsilon \in E_c \Rightarrow v_{1+i}(\varepsilon) = -1 \text{ and } v_3(\varepsilon) \geq 0; \quad \varepsilon \in E_q \Rightarrow v_{1+i}(\varepsilon) \geq 0 \text{ and } 3\varepsilon \bmod 3 \in A'.$$

In particular every $\varepsilon \in E$ has $v_{1+i}(\varepsilon) \geq -1$ and $v_3(\varepsilon) \geq -1$, with equality in the second exactly for type q.

3. FROM COLOURINGS TO A LINEAR PROBLEM OVER $\mathbb{Q}(i)$

Lemma 2. *Let F be a number field with $i \notin F$, and suppose that F^2 is 3-colourable. Then for every finite $V \subset T$ there is $\beta \in L$ with $\text{Tr}(\beta v) \in E$ for every $v \in V$.*

Proof. We may enlarge V , so we assume that it contains a $\mathbb{Q}(i)$ -basis $b_1, \dots, b_n$ of L . Such a basis exists in T : the $\mathbb{Q}(i)$ -span W of T is a subring of L , as T is a group; being finite-dimensional over $\mathbb{Q}(i)$ and contained in a field, it is a field. For $t \in F$ the element $z = (t+i)/(t-i)$ lies in T , so W contains $(z-1)^{-1}$ and $t = i(z+1)/(z-1)$; hence $W = L$.

For $v \in V$ write $D_v v = \sum_j \mu_{v,j} b_j$ with $D_v \in \mathbb{Z} \setminus \{0\}$ and $\mu_{v,j} \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$, and choose $N = 5^k$ with $N > 6r \max_v (|D_v| + \sum_j |\mu_{v,j}|)$. The set $U = G_N V$ is finite, symmetric ($-1 \in G_N$) and consists of unit vectors, so $\text{Cay}(\mathbb{Z}U, U)$ is a subgraph of $\text{Cay}(L, T)$ and is 3-colourable. By Theorem W^+ there is a character ξ of $\mathbb{Z}U$ with $\xi(U) \subseteq I + \mathbb{Z}$. Extend ξ to L (the group $\mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$ is divisible) and restrict it to a lattice $\Lambda = \frac{1}{M} \bigoplus_j \mathbb{Z}[i] f_j \supseteq U$, where $f_1, \dots, f_n$ is a $\mathbb{Q}$ -basis of F , so that $L = \bigoplus_j \mathbb{Q}(i) f_j$. A character of $\Lambda \cong \mathbb{Z}^{2n}$ lifts to a real-linear form, and every real-linear form on $\mathbb{C}^n$ is the real part of a $\mathbb{C}$ -linear one; so there is a $\mathbb{Q}(i)$ -linear map $\varphi : L \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ with $\xi(w) = \text{Re } \varphi(w) \bmod 1$ for $w \in \Lambda$. For $v \in V$ and $\gamma \in G_N$ we get $\xi(\gamma v) = \text{Re}(\gamma \varphi(v))$, so $\overline{\varphi(v)} \in S_N$, and $\varphi(v) \in S_N$ because G_N is closed under conjugation. Write $\varphi(v) = N\varepsilon_v + x_v$ as in Proposition 1. Applying φ to $D_v v - \sum_j \mu_{v,j} b_j = 0$ and Lemma 1 give $D_v \varepsilon_v = \sum_j \mu_{v,j} \varepsilon_{b_j}$. Let $\beta \in L$ be the element with $\text{Tr}(\beta b_j) = \varepsilon_{b_j}$ for all j . Then $D_v \text{Tr}(\beta v) = \sum_j \mu_{v,j} \varepsilon_{b_j} = D_v \varepsilon_v$, so $\text{Tr}(\beta v) = \varepsilon_v \in E$ for every $v \in V$. $\square$

Lemma 2 is also a practical test: if for some finite $V \subset T$ no such β exists, then F^2 is not 3-colourable. Whether β exists is a finite computation (Section 11).

4. LOCALISATION AT 2 AND 3

For a prime p let $L_p = L \otimes_{\mathbb{Q}} \mathbb{Q}_p = \prod_{w|p} L_w$, and for a place u of F let $L_u = L \otimes_F F_u$ and $T(F_u) = \{z \in L_u : z\bar{z} = 1\}$. Put $T_p = \prod_{u|p} T(F_u)$. Since 2 ramifies and 3 is inert in $\mathbb{Q}(i)$, $\mathbb{Q}(i) \otimes \mathbb{Q}_2 = \mathbb{Q}_2(i)$ and $\mathbb{Q}(i) \otimes \mathbb{Q}_3 = \mathbb{Q}_9$, the unramified quadratic extension of $\mathbb{Q}_3$; the trace extends to $\text{Tr} : L_2 \rightarrow \mathbb{Q}_2(i)$ and $\text{Tr} : L_3 \rightarrow \mathbb{Q}_9$. Let $O_2 = \mathbb{Z}_2[i]$, $O_3 = \mathbb{Z}_9$ (the integers of $\mathbb{Q}_9$), and $\mathcal{A} = \{\frac{\pm 1 \pm i}{3}\} + O_3$. By (1), $E_c \subseteq (1+i)^{-1} O_2^\times \cap O_3$ and $E_q \subseteq O_2 \cap \mathcal{A}$.

Lemma 3 (weak approximation for T). *For every finite set Σ of places of F , T is dense in $\prod_{u \in \Sigma} T(F_u)$.*

Proof. At a place u with $i \notin F_u$, $t \mapsto (t+i)/(t-i)$ is a homeomorphism from F_u onto $T(F_u) \setminus \{1\}$, with inverse $z \mapsto i(z+1)/(z-1)$. At a place with $i \in F_u$, $L_u \cong F_u \times F_u$, $T(F_u) = \{(s, s^{-1})\}$, and $t \mapsto (s, s^{-1})$ with $s = (t+i)/(t-i)$, $t^2 = -1$, is a homeomorphism from $F_u \setminus \{\pm i\}$ onto $T(F_u) \setminus \{1\}$. These maps send F into T , F is dense in $\prod_{u \in \Sigma} F_u$, and $T(F_u)$ has no isolated points. $\square$

Lemma 4. *If F^2 is 3-colourable and $i \notin F$, then one of the following holds:*

- (c) *there is $\beta_2 \in L_2$ with $v_{1+i}(\text{Tr}(\beta_2 z)) = -1$ for every $z \in T_2$;*
- (q) *there is $\beta_3 \in L_3$ with $\text{Tr}(\beta_3 z) \in \mathcal{A}$ for every $z \in T_3$.*

Proof. Fix a $\mathbb{Q}(i)$ -basis $b_1, \dots, b_n \subset T$ of L (proof of Lemma 2), and let

$$K_2 = \{\beta \in L_2 : \text{Tr}(\beta b_j) \in (1+i)^{-1} O_2 \ \forall j\}, \quad K_3 = \{\beta \in L_3 : \text{Tr}(\beta b_j) \in \frac{1}{3} O_3 \ \forall j\}.$$

They are compact, since $\beta \mapsto (\text{Tr}(\beta b_j))_j$ is a linear isomorphism onto $\mathbb{Q}_2(i)^n$, resp. $\mathbb{Q}_9^n$. On the compact space $\Omega = \{c, q\}^T \times K_2 \times K_3$ consider, for $v \in T$, the condition $P_v(\tau, \beta_2, \beta_3)$:

$$\tau(v) = c, \ v_{1+i}(\text{Tr}(\beta_2 v)) = -1, \ \text{Tr}(\beta_3 v) \in O_3; \quad \text{or} \quad \tau(v) = q, \ \text{Tr}(\beta_2 v) \in O_2, \ \text{Tr}(\beta_3 v) \in \mathcal{A}.$$

Each P_v defines a clopen subset of Ω . For a finite $V \supseteq \{b_1, \dots, b_n\}$, Lemma 2 gives $\beta \in L$; its images in L_2 and L_3 lie in K_2 and K_3 , and with $\tau(v)$ the type of $\text{Tr}(\beta v)$ the triple satisfies P_v for every $v \in V$, by (1). So the closed sets $\{P_v \text{ for all } v \in V\}$ have the finite intersection property, and some $(\tau, \beta_2, \beta_3) \in \Omega$ satisfies P_v for every $v \in T$.

For $z \in T_2$ let $a(z)$ be the statement $v_{1+i}(\text{Tr}(\beta_2 z)) = -1$ and $a'(z)$ the statement $\text{Tr}(\beta_2 z) \in O_2$; for $y \in T_3$ let $b(y)$ be $\text{Tr}(\beta_3 y) \in O_3$ and $b'(y)$ be $\text{Tr}(\beta_3 y) \in \mathcal{A}$. They are locally constant, a and a' exclude each other, and so do b and b' . The set

$$Z = \{(z, y) \in T_2 \times T_3 : (a(z) \wedge b(y)) \vee (a'(z) \wedge b'(y))\}$$

is clopen and contains the diagonal image of T , which is dense by Lemma 3; so $Z = T_2 \times T_3$. If $a(z_0)$ holds for some z_0 , then $b(y)$ holds for every y , so b' holds nowhere, and $a(z)$ holds for every z : this is (c). Otherwise a' holds everywhere, and then b' holds everywhere: this is (q). $\square$

Case (c). For $z \in L$ let $g(z) = (1+i)\text{Tr}(\beta_2 z) \in \mathbb{Q}_2(i)$. Fix a representative ρ of each class of $\mathbb{Q}_2(i)$ modulo O_2 , and colour z by $(g(z) - \rho) \bmod (1+i) \in O_2/(1+i) = \mathbb{F}_2$, where ρ represents the class of $g(z)$. A unit step $v \in T$ adds $g(v) \in O_2^\times$ to $g(z)$: it keeps the class modulo O_2 and changes the residue modulo $1+i$. This is a proper 2-colouring of $L \cong F^2$, so by [13, Theorem 1] some prime of F above 2 ramifies in $F(i)$.

5. CASE (Q): THE PLACES ABOVE 3

Let u be a place of F above 3, $f = f_u$ its residue degree, $q = 3^f$, and $g_u(z) = \text{Tr}_{L_u/\mathbb{Q}_9}(\beta_u z)$, where $\beta_3 = (\beta_u)_u$; then $\text{Tr}(\beta_3 y) = \sum_u g_u(y_u)$ for $y = (y_u) \in T_3$.

Even f . Then $\mathbb{F}_9$ lies in the residue field of F_u , so $i \in F_u$, $L_u \cong F_u \times F_u$ and $T(F_u) = \{(s, s^{-1}) : s \in F_u^\times\}$. Write $g_u(s, t) = \ell_1(s) + \ell_2(t)$ with $\mathbb{Q}_3$ -linear $\ell_1, \ell_2 : F_u \rightarrow \mathbb{Q}_9$. In case (q), $g_u(y_u)$ stays in a bounded set when y_u varies and the other components are fixed. If $\ell_1(s_0) \neq 0$, then $g_u(3^{-m}s_0, 3^m s_0^{-1}) = 3^{-m}\ell_1(s_0) + 3^m\ell_2(s_0^{-1})$ is unbounded as $m \rightarrow \infty$; so $\ell_1 = 0$, likewise $\ell_2 = 0$, and $g_u = 0$.

Odd f . Then $L_u = F_u(i) = F_u\mathbb{Q}_9$ is a field, unramified of degree 2 over F_u , with residue field $\mathbb{F}_{q^2}$; its non-trivial automorphism σ acts on $\mathbb{Q}_9$ as the Frobenius ($\sigma(i) = -i$). The group $T(F_u)$ lies in $O_{L_u}^\times$, contains $\mu_4 \subset \mathbb{Q}_9$ and the Teichmüller lifts of $\mu_{q+1} \subset \mathbb{F}_{q^2}^\times$ (as $\zeta\sigma(\zeta) = \zeta^{1+q}$), and reduces onto μ_{q+1} . Since g_u is $\mathbb{Q}_9$ -linear, $g_u(\epsilon z) = \epsilon g_u(z)$ for $\epsilon \in \mu_4$.

Lemma 5 (one place). *In case (q) there are a place $u_0 \mid 3$ of odd residue degree and $\beta \in L_{u_0}$ with $\text{Tr}_{L_{u_0}/\mathbb{Q}_9}(\beta z) \in \mathcal{A}$ for every $z \in T(F_{u_0})$.*

Proof. Only the places of odd residue degree contribute. For such a place u and $z, z' \in T(F_u)$, varying y_u alone gives $g_u(z) - g_u(z') \in \mathcal{A} - \mathcal{A} \subseteq \frac{1}{3}O_3$. With $z' = 1$ and $z = i$ this says $(i-1)g_u(1) \in \frac{1}{3}O_3$, and $i-1$ is a unit at 3; so $g_u(T(F_u)) \subseteq \frac{1}{3}O_3$. Let $Z_u \subseteq \mathbb{F}_9$ be the set of residues of $3g_u(z)$, $z \in T(F_u)$; it is stable under μ_4 , and (q) says that $\sum_u z_u \in A'$ for every choice of $z_u \in Z_u$. Suppose two places $u \neq u'$ had nonzero elements $w \in Z_u$ and $w' \in Z_{u'}$. Fix $z_{u''} \in Z_{u''}$ at the other places and put $c = \epsilon'w' + \sum z_{u''}$ with $\epsilon' \in \mu_4$. The four distinct elements $c + \epsilon w$, $\epsilon \in \mu_4$, lie in A' , which has four elements; so they are all of A' , and summing them gives $4c = c = \sum A' = 0$. As this holds for every $\epsilon' \in \mu_4$, $w' = iw'$, so $w' = 0$: a contradiction. Since $0 \notin A'$, exactly one place u_0 has $Z_{u_0} \neq \{0\}$; the other g_u take values in O_3 , and $\beta = \beta_{u_0}$ works, because $\mathcal{A} + O_3 = \mathcal{A}$. $\square$

Lemma 6 (level one). *Let $u \mid 3$ have odd residue degree f , and let $\beta \in L_u$ satisfy $\text{Tr}_{L_u/\mathbb{Q}_9}(\beta z) \in \mathcal{A}$ for every $z \in T(F_u)$. Then $\lambda(x) = 3 \text{Tr}_{L_u/\mathbb{Q}_9}(\beta x) \bmod 3$ is defined on O_{L_u} and vanishes on its maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}$, and the induced $\mathbb{F}_9$ -linear map $\lambda_1 : \mathbb{F}_{q^2} \rightarrow \mathbb{F}_9$ satisfies $\lambda_1(\mu_{q+1}) \subseteq A'$.*

Proof. The closed additive span R of $T(F_u)$ is a closed subring of O_{L_u} . It contains $\mathbb{Z}_3[\mu_{q+1}]$, which is the ring of integers W of the unramified extension of $\mathbb{Q}_3$ of degree $2f$ (the order of 3 modulo $q+1$ is $2f$). Let π be a uniformiser of F_u . Then $z = (\pi+i)/(\pi-i)$ and $\sigma(z) = z^{-1}$ lie in $T(F_u)$, and $2-z-\sigma(z) = 4/(\pi^2+1)$ is a unit of O_{L_u} in R ; its inverse is a limit of its powers, so $(\pi^2+1)/4 \in R$, and $\pi = (z-\sigma(z))(\pi^2+1)/(4i) \in R$. Hence $R \supseteq W[\pi] = O_{L_u}$, since π is also a uniformiser of L_u . By continuity $\text{Tr}(\beta O_{L_u}) \subseteq \frac{1}{3}O_3$, so $\lambda : O_{L_u} \rightarrow \mathbb{F}_9$ is defined, $\mathbb{Z}_9$ -linear, and zero on $3O_{L_u} = \mathfrak{m}^e$.

Suppose $\lambda(\mathfrak{m}) \neq 0$, and let $j \geq 1$ be the largest integer with $\lambda(\mathfrak{m}^j) \neq 0$. Identify $\mathfrak{m}^j/\mathfrak{m}^{j+1}$ with $\mathbb{F}_{q^2}$ through $x \mapsto (x/\pi^j) \bmod \mathfrak{m}$; then λ induces a nonzero additive map $\lambda_j : \mathbb{F}_{q^2} \rightarrow \mathbb{F}_9$. For $\eta \in O_{F_u}$ the element $t = (1+i\pi^j\eta)/(1-i\pi^j\eta)$ lies in $T(F_u)$ (as $\sigma(t) = t^{-1}$), and $t \equiv 1 + 2i\pi^j\eta \pmod{\mathfrak{m}^{j+1}}$. For $z \in T(F_u)$ with residue $\hat{z} \in \mu_{q+1}$ this gives $\lambda(zt) = \lambda(z) + \lambda_j(2i\hat{z}\hat{\eta})$, where $\hat{\eta}$ is the residue of η . As $\hat{\eta}$ runs over $\mathbb{F}_q$, the second term runs over an additive subgroup Σ_z of $\mathbb{F}_9$, and $\lambda(z) + \Sigma_z \subseteq A'$. But $A' = \{a + bi : a, b \neq 0\}$ contains no coset of a nonzero subgroup of $\mathbb{F}_9$, so $\Sigma_z = 0$: λ_j vanishes on $i\hat{z}\mathbb{F}_q$ for every $\hat{z} \in \mu_{q+1}$. These sets span $\mathbb{F}_{q^2}$ additively, because the

$\mathbb{F}_q$ -span of μ_{q+1} is a subfield not contained in $\mathbb{F}_q$; so $\lambda_j = 0$, a contradiction. Hence $\lambda(\mathbf{m}) = 0$, the induced map λ_1 is $\mathbb{F}_9$ -linear, and $\lambda_1(\mu_{q+1}) \subseteq A'$ because $T(F_u)$ reduces onto μ_{q+1} . $\square$

Lemma 7 (residue fields). *Let f be odd and $q = 3^f$. There is an $\mathbb{F}_9$ -linear map $\lambda_1 : \mathbb{F}_{q^2} \rightarrow \mathbb{F}_9$ with $\lambda_1(\mu_{q+1}) \subseteq A'$ if and only if $f = 1$.*

Proof. For $f = 1$, $\mu_4 \subset \mathbb{F}_9$ and $\lambda_1(x) = (1+i)x$ works. Let $f \geq 3$. Every $\mathbb{F}_9$ -linear map is $\lambda_1(x) = \text{Tr}_{\mathbb{F}_{q^2}/\mathbb{F}_9}(bx) = \sum_{j < f} (bx)^{9^j}$ for some $b \in \mathbb{F}_{q^2}$. In characteristic 3,

$$\lambda_1(z)^4 = \lambda_1(z)^3 \lambda_1(z) = \sum_{j,k < f} b^{e_{jk}} z^{e_{jk}}, \quad e_{jk} = 3 \cdot 9^j + 9^k.$$

Since $A' = \{y : y^4 = -1\}$, if $\lambda_1(\mu_{q+1}) \subseteq A'$ then $\Phi(z) = 1 + \sum_{j,k} b^{e_{jk}} z^{e_{jk}}$ vanishes on μ_{q+1} . On this cyclic group, of order prime to 3, the characters $z \mapsto z^e$ ($e \bmod q+1$) are linearly independent; so for every class $e \bmod q+1$ the sum of the coefficients of the $z^{e_{jk}}$ with $e_{jk} \equiv e$ vanishes (or equals -1 , for $e \equiv 0$).

Modulo $q+1$, $g = -3$ satisfies $g^f = -3^f \equiv 1$ (as f is odd), $9^j \equiv g^{2j}$ and $3 \cdot 9^j \equiv -g^{2j+1}$. Let $e_{j'k'} \equiv e_{jj} = 4 \cdot 9^j$. Multiplying by g^{-2j} gives $4 \equiv -g^\alpha + g^\gamma$ with $\alpha \equiv 2j' + 1 - 2j$ and $\gamma \equiv 2k' - 2j \pmod{f}$, $0 \leq \alpha, \gamma < f$. As integers, $(-3)^\alpha$ and $(-3)^\gamma$ have absolute value at most 3^{f-1} , and $4 + 2 \cdot 3^{f-1} < 3^f + 1$ for $f \geq 3$; so the congruence is the equality $(-3)^\gamma - (-3)^\alpha = 4$. It forces $\gamma = 0$ (otherwise 3 divides the left side, or $(-3)^\gamma = 5$), then $(-3)^\alpha = -3$ and $\alpha = 1$; so $j' = k' = j$, as 2 is invertible modulo f . Hence the class of $4 \cdot 9^j$ contains only e_{jj} , it is not 0 (because $q+1 > 4$ and $3 \nmid q+1$), and its coefficient $b^{4 \cdot 9^j}$ must vanish. So $b = 0$, and then $\Phi = 1 \neq 0$. $\square$

Proof of Theorem B. If $i \in F$, then (a) and (b) fail ($F(i) = F$, and every residue field above 3 contains $\mathbb{F}_9$), and $\chi(F^2) = \infty$ by a theorem of Davies [2] (see [12, Proposition 3]); so the theorem holds. Let $i \notin F$.

Only if. Let F^2 be 3-colourable. By Lemma 4, (c) or (q) holds. In case (c), Section 4 gives (a). In case (q), Lemmas 5 and 6 give a place $u_0 \mid 3$ of odd residue degree f and an $\mathbb{F}_9$ -linear $\lambda_1 : \mathbb{F}_{q^2} \rightarrow \mathbb{F}_9$ with $\lambda_1(\mu_{q+1}) \subseteq A'$, and Lemma 7 gives $f = 1$: this is (b).

If. Under (a) the plane is 2-colourable [18, Theorem A'], [13, Theorem 1]. Under (b), let $u \mid 3$ have residue degree 1 and let w be the place of L above it. Then $i \notin F_u$, $L_w = F_u(i)$ has residue field $\mathbb{F}_9$, and the unit vectors of F_u^2 are units of O_w whose residues lie in μ_4 . A unit step preserves the class of z modulo O_w ; fix a representative ρ of each class and colour z by $\ell((z - \rho) \bmod \mathfrak{m}_w)$, where $\ell(a + bi) = a + b$ on $\mathbb{F}_9 = \mathbb{F}_3 + \mathbb{F}_3 i$. Since $\ell(\pm 1) = \pm 1$ and $\ell(\pm i) = \pm 1$, every unit step changes the colour. This colours $F_u^2 \supseteq F^2$ with three colours. Finally $\chi(F^2) \leq 2$ if and only if (a), by [13, Theorem 1]. $\square$

The proof uses Theorem W^+ only through Lemma 2, for the finite sets $G_N V$; the rest is compactness, weak approximation for the norm-one torus, the arithmetic of the places above 2 and 3, and, in case (c), the two-colour theorem of [13].

6. CONSEQUENCES

Corollary 1 (no circular chromatic number between 2 and 3). *Let F be a number field. If F^2 has a homomorphism to a circular clique $K_{p/q}$ with $p/q < 3$, then $\chi(F^2) \leq 2$. Hence $\chi_c(F^2) = 2$, $\chi_c(F^2) = 3$ or $\chi_c(F^2) > 3$, according as $\chi(F^2) = 2, 3$ or at least 4; and F^2 has a homomorphism to a cycle of odd length at least 5 only if it is bipartite.*

Proof. If $i \in F$ there is nothing to prove, so let $i \notin F$. For every finite U as in the proof of Lemma 2, Theorem W^+ gives a character with $\xi(U) \subseteq [q/p, 1 - q/p] + \mathbb{Z}$, and $q/p > 1/3$. In that proof $\varphi(v)$ then satisfies $\text{Re}(\overline{\varphi(v)}) \in [q/p, 1 - q/p] + \mathbb{Z}$ (take $\gamma = 1$), while a point $N\varepsilon$ with $\varepsilon \in E_q$ (by Proposition 1 these are the points of type q) has real part in $\{\frac{1}{3}, \frac{2}{3}\} + \mathbb{Z}$, as $3 \nmid N$. So every ε_v has type c, the conditions P_v in the proof of Lemma 4 can all be taken with $\tau(v) = c$, and (c) holds; so $\chi(F^2) \leq 2$. For the second statement: if $\chi_c(F^2) < 3$, then by the definition of the infimum F^2 maps to some $K_{p/q}$ with $p/q < 3$, so $\chi(F^2) \leq 2$; hence $\chi_c(F^2) = 3$ when

$\chi(F^2) = 3$, as $\chi_c \leq \chi$. If $\chi(F^2) \geq 4$, then by the theorem of de Bruijn and Erdős [4] some finite subgraph H has $\chi(H) \geq 4$, so $\chi_c(F^2) \geq \chi_c(H) > \chi(H) - 1 \geq 3$. $\square$

Call a number field F *split above 2 and 3* if $i \in F_v$ for every place v of F above 2 and above 3, that is, if every such place splits in $F(i)$; then (a) and (b) fail. The admissible fields of [13, Section 4], which must moreover satisfy $\sqrt{3} \notin F$ and $i \in F_v$ at the places above 7, 11 and 19, are split above 2 and 3.

Corollary 2. *Every number field F that is split above 2 and 3 has $\chi(F^2) \geq 4$.*

A real quadratic field $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{d})$ is split above 2 and 3 exactly when $d \equiv 23 \pmod{24}$, so for quadratic fields Corollary 2 is contained in [11]. Of the biquadratic fields listed as admissible in the account of [9, `notes/local_global.md`, Section 4], $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{47})$, $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{11}, \sqrt{13})$ and $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{10}, \sqrt{38})$ (which contains $\sqrt{95}$) contain some $\sqrt{d}$ with $d \equiv 11 \pmod{12}$; for $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{31})$ and $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{55})$ the bound is new.

Corollary 3 (local fields). *Let K be a finite extension of $\mathbb{Q}_p$. Then $\chi(K^2) = 2$ if $p = 2$ and $K(i)/K$ is ramified, $\chi(K^2) = 3$ if $p = 3$ and the residue degree of K is 1, and $\chi(K^2) \geq 4$ in every other case.*

Proof. In the first case the 2-colouring of the proof of [13, Proposition 3] colours K^2 itself (that proof colours F_v^2 , and it applies verbatim to every finite extension K of $\mathbb{Q}_2$ with $K(i)/K$ ramified); in the second case the 3-colouring of the proof of Theorem B colours K^2 itself; and $\chi(K^2) \geq 3$ when $p = 3$, because $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{7}) \subset \mathbb{Q}_3 \subseteq K$ and $\chi(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{7})^2) = 3$. If $p \geq 5$, then $\chi(K^2) \geq \chi(\mathbb{Q}_p^2) \geq 4$ by [11, Corollary 3]. If $i \in K$, then $\chi(K^2) = \infty$ [12, Proposition 3]. There remain the case $p = 2$, $i \notin K$, $K(i)/K$ unramified, and the case $p = 3$ with odd residue degree at least 3. In both we find a number field $F \subset K$ for which (a) and (b) fail; then $\chi(K^2) \geq \chi(F^2) \geq 4$ by Theorem B.

Let $m = [K : \mathbb{Q}_p]$ and let p' be the other element of $\{2, 3\}$. If $p = 2$, then m is even: if m were odd, $\mathbb{Q}_2^\times / \mathbb{Q}_2^{\times 2}$ would inject into $K^\times / K^{\times 2}$, and since -1 and -5 are not squares in $\mathbb{Q}_2$, $i \notin K$ and $K(i) \neq K(\sqrt{5})$, which is the unramified quadratic extension of K ; so $K(i)/K$ would be ramified. Choose monic polynomials over $\mathbb{Q}_p$, $\mathbb{Q}_{p'}$ and $\mathbb{Q}_5$ of a common even degree n :

- over $\mathbb{Q}_p$, $h_K h'$, where h_K is the minimal polynomial of a generator of K and h' is a product of distinct irreducible quadratics, coprime to h_K , whose roots generate $\mathbb{Q}_2(i)$ (if $p = 2$) or $\mathbb{Q}_9$ (if $p = 3$); if $p = 3$ and m is odd, h' also contains one cubic factor, coprime to h_K , generating the unramified cubic extension $\mathbb{Q}_{27}$ of $\mathbb{Q}_3$;
- over $\mathbb{Q}_{p'}$, a product of distinct irreducible quadratics whose roots generate $\mathbb{Q}_2(i)$, resp. $\mathbb{Q}_9$;
- over $\mathbb{Q}_5$, an irreducible polynomial.

By weak approximation choose a monic $h \in \mathbb{Q}[x]$ whose coefficients are so close to the three targets that, by Krasner's lemma, h factors over $\mathbb{Q}_p$, $\mathbb{Q}_{p'}$ and $\mathbb{Q}_5$ with the same degrees and the same fields as the targets. Then $F = \mathbb{Q}[x]/(h)$ is a field (as h is irreducible over $\mathbb{Q}_5$); it embeds in K , through a root of h close to the chosen generator of K ; its places above p are the place that gives K and places that contain i (or, for the cubic factor, have residue degree 3); and its places above p' all contain i . So no place above 2 ramifies in $F(i)$ and no place above 3 has residue degree 1. $\square$

For example $\chi(\mathbb{Q}_{27}^2) \geq 4$, although $i \notin \mathbb{Q}_{27}$ and $x^2 + y^2$ is anisotropic over $\mathbb{Q}_{27}$, as over $\mathbb{Q}_3$; and $\chi(\mathbb{Q}_2(\sqrt{3})^2) \geq 4$, as $\mathbb{Q}_2(\sqrt{3}, i) = \mathbb{Q}_2(\sqrt{3}, \sqrt{-3})$ is unramified over $\mathbb{Q}_2(\sqrt{3})$ (this also follows from $\chi(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{11})^2) = 4$, since $\mathbb{Q}_2(\sqrt{11}) = \mathbb{Q}_2(\sqrt{3})$). Corollary 3 extends [11, Corollary 3] ($p \geq 5$) and the values $\chi(\mathbb{Q}_2^2) = 2$ and $\chi(\mathbb{Q}_3^2) = 3$, which follow from Madore's results [17] (see [12, Theorem 2]).

7. AN EXPLICIT FAMILY: TWO SQUARE ROOTS

For many fields the general argument can be replaced by two explicit relations. For $c \geq 1$ put

$$u_c = \frac{(1 + i\sqrt{c})^2}{1 + c} = \frac{(1 - c) + 2\sqrt{c}i}{1 + c}, \quad \text{so that} \quad (1 + c)(u_c + \bar{u}_c) = 2(1 - c).$$

Proposition 2. *Let $F \subset \mathbb{R}$ contain $\sqrt{a}$ and $\sqrt{b}$, where $a \equiv 2 \pmod{3}$ and $b \equiv 7 \pmod{8}$ are positive integers ($a = b$ is allowed), and let $N = 5^k > \frac{4\sqrt{10}}{3} \max(a, b)$. Then no character of the group generated by $U = G_N\{1, u_a, \bar{u}_a, u_b, \bar{u}_b\}$ maps every element of U into $[1/3, 2/3] + \mathbb{Z}$. Hence $\chi(F^2) \geq 4$.*

Proof. As in the proof of Lemma 2, such a character gives numbers $w_v = \varphi(v) \in S_N$ ($v \in \{1, u_a, \bar{u}_a, u_b, \bar{u}_b\}$) that satisfy the two relations exactly. The sums of the absolute values of their coefficients are $4a$ and $4b$, and $6r \cdot 4c = \frac{4\sqrt{10}}{3}c < N$; so Lemma 1 gives, for the types,

$$(1+a)(\varepsilon_{u_a} + \varepsilon_{\bar{u}_a}) = 2(1-a)\varepsilon_1, \quad (1+b)(\varepsilon_{u_b} + \varepsilon_{\bar{u}_b}) = 2(1-b)\varepsilon_1.$$

At 3. $3 \mid 1+a$ and $3 \nmid 2(1-a)$. By (1) the left side of the first relation has $v_3 \geq 0$, hence $v_3(\varepsilon_1) \geq 0$, and ε_1 is not of type q. At 2. $v_2(1+b) \geq 3$ and $v_2(2(1-b)) = 2$, as $1-b \equiv 2 \pmod{8}$. By (1) the left side of the second relation has $v_{1+i} \geq 2 \cdot 3 - 1 = 5$, while $v_{1+i}(2(1-b)\varepsilon_1) = 4 + v_{1+i}(\varepsilon_1) = 3$ if ε_1 has type c. So ε_1 is not of type c either, a contradiction. $\square$

For $a = b = d$ this is the case $d \equiv 23 \pmod{24}$ of [11, Theorem 1], where [11, Theorem 4(1)] needs only $d < 21 \cdot 5^{k-1}$. Proposition 2 covers, for example, $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{7})$, $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{31})$, $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{5}, \sqrt{7})$, $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{55})$ and $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{3}, \sqrt{5})$ (with $b = 15$), and every field containing one of them. In terms of Theorem B, $\sqrt{a}$ makes every place above 3 have even residue degree, and $\sqrt{b}$ puts i in every completion above 2.

8. CIRCULAR COLOURINGS

For the plane over $\mathbb{R}$, DeVos, Ebrahimi, Ghebleh, Goddyn, Mohar and Naserasr proved $\chi_c(\mathbb{R}^2) \geq 4$ [6]; since de Grey's theorem gives a finite subgraph with $\chi = 5$, in fact $\chi_c(\mathbb{R}^2) > 4$. For planes over number fields the values 2 and 3 are immediate (a bipartite plane; a plane with $\chi = 3$ containing a unit triangle), and by Corollary 1 the planes with $\chi_c \leq 3$ are exactly those with $\chi \leq 3$. We know of no earlier non-integral value. Theorem C shows that $7/2$ occurs; its upper bound comes from a residue field.

Proposition 3. *Let v be a place of F whose residue field is $\mathbb{F}_p$, with $p \equiv 3 \pmod{4}$, and let $\lambda : \mathbb{F}_{p^2} \rightarrow \mathbb{F}_p$ be $\mathbb{F}_p$ -linear with $\lambda(\mu_{p+1}) \subseteq \{m, m+1, \dots, p-m\}$. Then F_v^2 , hence F^2 , has a homomorphism to $K_{p/m}$. For $p = 7$, $\lambda(a+bi) = 2a+3b$ takes the values 2, 3, 4, 5 on $\mu_8 \subset \mathbb{F}_{49}$, so F^2 maps to $K_{7/2}$, and $\chi_c(F^2) \leq 7/2$.*

Proof. As -1 is not a square in $\mathbb{F}_p$, $i \notin F_v$, and $L_w = F_v(i)$ is unramified over F_v with residue field $\mathbb{F}_{p^2}$. A unit vector z has $z\bar{z} = 1$, so it is a unit of O_w , and since the conjugation of L_w/F_v reduces to the Frobenius $x \mapsto x^p$, its residue satisfies $\hat{z}^{p+1} = 1$. A unit step preserves the class modulo O_w ; fix a representative ρ of each class and colour z by $\lambda((z-\rho) \bmod \mathfrak{m}_w) \in \mathbb{Z}/p$. A unit step changes the colour by an element of $\{m, \dots, p-m\}$. For $p = 7$, $\mu_8 = \{\pm 1, \pm i, \pm 2 \pm 2i\}$, and $2a+3b$ takes the values 2, 5, 3, 4, 3, 5, 2, 4 at $1, -1, i, -i, 2+2i, 2-2i, -2+2i, -2-2i$. $\square$

Proof of Theorem C. Upper bounds. 7 splits in $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{11})$ ($11 \equiv 2^2 \pmod{7}$) and ramifies in $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{35})$, so both fields, and $\mathbb{Q}_7$, have a place with residue field $\mathbb{F}_7$; Proposition 3 applies.

Lower bounds. For $d \in \{11, 35\}$ let $u_n = (n + i\sqrt{d})^2 / (n^2 + d)$, $V = \{1, u_1, \bar{u}_1, u_7, \bar{u}_7, u_{19}, \bar{u}_{19}\}$ and $U = G_{25}V$, a set of 140 unit vectors (70 up to sign). We checked by computer that no character of $\mathbb{Z}U$ maps every element of U into the open interval $(2/7, 5/7) + \mathbb{Z}$. The certificate branches on the integer values of the relations among the vectors (66 relations; 17 744 nodes for $d = 11$ and 14 199 for $d = 35$) and closes every leaf with an exact Farkas vector; two exact checkers that share no code accept it (Section 11). If F^2 , $F = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{d})$, mapped to $K_{p/q}$ with $p/q < 7/2$, Theorem W⁺ would give a character with values in $[q/p, 1 - q/p] \subset (2/7, 5/7)$ on U . So $\chi_c(F^2) \geq 7/2$. Since $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{11}) \subset \mathbb{Q}_7$, also $\chi_c(\mathbb{Q}_7^2) \geq 7/2$.

Chromatic numbers. $K_{7/2} \rightarrow K_4$ gives $\chi \leq 4$, and $\chi \geq \chi_c = 7/2 > 3$ gives $\chi \geq 4$ (for the two quadratic fields this is also [11, Theorem 1], for $\mathbb{Q}_7$ [12, Theorem 2]). The last sentence of the theorem is Corollary 1. $\square$

The lower bound is about the infinite graph $\text{Cay}(\mathbb{Z}U, U)$, to which Theorem W^+ is applied directly; we do not know a finite unit-distance graph with circular chromatic number exactly $7/2$. The open interval is essential: the characters that come from the 7-adic colourings take values in the closed interval $[2/7, 5/7]$ on U . The certificates were found with a floating-point mixed-integer solver, which reports $\max_{\xi} \min_{u \in U} \|\xi(u)\| = 2/7$ for both sets; nothing in the proof depends on it.

The circular chromatic number separates planes with the same chromatic number:

Proposition 4. $\chi_c(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{59})^2) \geq 53/15 > 7/2$, while $\chi(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{59})^2) = 4$.

Proof. For $d = 59$ the same set $U = G_{25}V$ has no character into the open interval $(15/53, 38/53)$: the certificate has 127 181 nodes and 105 761 leaves, and both checkers accept it (Section 11). As in the proof of Theorem C, Theorem W^+ gives $\chi_c \geq 53/15$. Here 7 is inert, so Proposition 3 does not apply. We have $\chi \geq 4$ by [11, Theorem 1], as $59 \equiv 11 \pmod{12}$. And $\chi \leq 4$: let v be the place of $F = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{59})$ above 2. As $59 \cdot 3 \equiv 1 \pmod{8}$, $F_v = \mathbb{Q}_2(\sqrt{59}) = \mathbb{Q}_2(\sqrt{3})$, and $L_w = F_v(i) = \mathbb{Q}_2(\sqrt{3}, \sqrt{-3})$ is unramified over F_v , with residue field $\mathbb{F}_4$. So the unit vectors are units of O_w whose residues lie in the group $\mu_3 = \mathbb{F}_4^\times$, and, as in the proof of Proposition 3, colouring each class of L_w modulo O_w by the residue modulo $\mathfrak{m}_w$ is a proper 4-colouring (a bound of Fischer [7]). $\square$

Theorem F gives more: $\chi_c(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{59})^2) = 4$. Proposition 4 is a finite form of the separation: 70 explicit unit vectors already push χ_c above $7/2$.

Corollary 4. $\chi_c(E^2) = 7/2$ for every finite extension E of $\mathbb{Q}_7$ with residue degree 1, and $\chi_c(F^2) = 7/2$ for every number field F that contains $\sqrt{11}$ or $\sqrt{35}$ and has a place above 7 of residue degree 1, for example $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{7}, \sqrt{11})$ and $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{35})$.

Proof. $E \supseteq \mathbb{Q}_7 \supset \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{11})$ and $F \supseteq \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{11})$ or $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{35})$ give $\chi_c \geq 7/2$ by Theorem C; the residue field $\mathbb{F}_7$ gives $\chi_c \leq 7/2$ by Proposition 3 (whose proof applies to E itself). $\square$

Locally constant colourings. The values 2, 3 and $7/2$ are the only ones below 4 that colourings through a single completion can give (Corollary 5). Let E be a finite extension of $\mathbb{Q}_p$ with $i \notin E$ and $E(i)/E$ unramified (for p odd this always holds; for $p = 2$ it is the case where (a) fails), let $\mathbb{F}_q$ be the residue field of E ($q = p^f$), w the place of $L = E(i)$, and

$$\kappa_1(E) = \max_{\lambda} \min_{z \in \mu_{q+1}} \|\lambda(z)\|,$$

the maximum over the additive maps $\lambda : \mathbb{F}_{q^2} \rightarrow \frac{1}{p}\mathbb{Z}/\mathbb{Z}$.

Proposition 5. Suppose E^2 has a locally constant homomorphism to $K_{P/Q}$, $P/Q < 4$. Then $Q/P \leq \kappa_1(E)$. Conversely E^2 maps to $K_{p/m}$ when $m/p = \kappa_1(E) > 0$.

Proof. The converse is the colouring of Proposition 3, with $\mathbb{F}_q$ in place of $\mathbb{F}_p$. Let π be a uniformiser of E (also one of L) and σ the non-trivial automorphism of L/E . On the compact set O_w the homomorphism is constant on the cosets of some power $\mathfrak{m}^k$ of the maximal ideal, and only its restriction to O_w is used. It induces a homomorphism from $\text{Cay}(O_w/\mathfrak{m}^k, \bar{T})$, where $\bar{T}$ is the image of $T(E)$, to $K_{P/Q}$; by Theorem W^+ there is a character ξ of $O_w/\mathfrak{m}^k$ with $\|\xi(z)\| \geq Q/P > 1/4 \geq 1/(2p)$ for every $z \in T(E)$. We show that ξ vanishes on $\mathfrak{m}$; then ξ is a map λ as in the definition of κ_1 , and $Q/P \leq \kappa_1(E)$, since $T(E)$ reduces onto μ_{q+1} (it contains the Teichmüller lifts of μ_{q+1} , on which σ acts as $x \mapsto x^q$). Suppose not, and let $J \geq 1$ be the largest integer with $\xi(\mathfrak{m}^J) \neq 0$. Through $x \mapsto (x/\pi^J) \bmod \mathfrak{m}$, ξ induces a nonzero additive map $\lambda_J : \mathbb{F}_{q^2} \rightarrow \frac{1}{p}\mathbb{Z}/\mathbb{Z}$. For $x \in O_w$, $t = (1 + \pi^J x)/\sigma(1 + \pi^J x)$ lies in $T(E)$ and $t \equiv 1 + \pi^J(x - \sigma(x)) \pmod{\mathfrak{m}^{J+1}}$, and the residues of $x - \sigma(x)$ fill the $\mathbb{F}_q$ -line $D = \{y - y^q : y \in \mathbb{F}_{q^2}\}$. For $z \in T(E)$ with residue $\hat{z}$, $\xi(zt) = \xi(z) + \lambda_J(\hat{z}d)$, $d \in D$; the values $\lambda_J(\hat{z}D)$ form a subgroup of $\frac{1}{p}\mathbb{Z}/\mathbb{Z}$, and if it were the whole group, $\xi(T(E))$ would contain a coset of $\frac{1}{p}\mathbb{Z}/\mathbb{Z}$ and a point with $\|\cdot\| \leq \frac{1}{2p}$. So λ_J vanishes on $\hat{z}D$ for every $\hat{z} \in \mu_{q+1}$, hence on their additive span, which is D times the $\mathbb{F}_q$ -span of μ_{q+1} , that is $\mathbb{F}_{q^2}$: a contradiction. $\square$

Proposition 6. $\kappa_1(E) > 1/4$ only when $p = 3$ and $f = 1$, where $\kappa_1 = 1/3$, or $p = 7$ and $f = 1$, where $\kappa_1 = 2/7$. In every other case with $i \notin E$ and $E(i)/E$ unramified, $\kappa_1(E) < 1/4$; it is 0 when $p = 2$ or $f \geq 3$.

Proof. For $p = 2$: if $\lambda(\mu_{q+1}) = \{\frac{1}{2}\}$, summing over μ_{q+1} , whose elements add up to 0, gives $\lambda(0) = \frac{q+1}{2} \equiv \frac{1}{2}$, as $q+1$ is odd; so some z has $\lambda(z) = 0$.

Let p be odd; then $p \equiv 3 \pmod{4}$ and f is odd, as $i \notin E$. Let $\psi(x) = e^{2\pi i x/p}$ on $\mathbb{F}_p$, and $S(b) = \sum_{z \in \mu_{q+1}} \psi(\text{Tr}_{\mathbb{F}_{q^2}/\mathbb{F}_p}(bz))$ for $b \in \mathbb{F}_{q^2}^\times$. Every additive $\lambda : \mathbb{F}_{q^2} \rightarrow \frac{1}{p}\mathbb{Z}/\mathbb{Z}$ is $z \mapsto \frac{1}{p} \text{Tr}(bz)$ for some b . Writing the indicator function of $\mu_{q+1} = \ker N_{\mathbb{F}_{q^2}/\mathbb{F}_q}$ with the multiplicative characters χ of $\mathbb{F}_q^\times$, and using the Davenport–Hasse relation $G(\chi \circ N, \psi \circ \text{Tr}) = -G(\chi, \psi_q)^2$ for Gauss sums [3] ($\psi_q = \psi \circ \text{Tr}_{\mathbb{F}_q/\mathbb{F}_p}$; see [16, Chapter 5]), one finds

$$S(b) = \frac{1}{q-1} \sum_{\chi} \bar{\chi}(N(b)) G(\chi \circ N, \psi \circ \text{Tr}) = - \sum_{y \in \mathbb{F}_q^\times} \psi_q\left(y + \frac{N(b)}{y}\right),$$

minus a Kloosterman sum; so $|S(b)| \leq 2\sqrt{q}$ by Weil’s bound [21]. Hence, for $b \neq 0$, the number of $z \in \mu_{q+1}$ with $\text{Tr}(bz) = 0$ is $\frac{1}{p} \sum_{a \in \mathbb{F}_p} \sum_z \psi(a \text{Tr}(bz)) = \frac{q+1}{p} + \frac{1}{p} \sum_{a \neq 0} S(ab) \geq \frac{q+1}{p} - \frac{p-1}{p} 2\sqrt{q}$, which is positive when $f \geq 3$ (then $\sqrt{q} \geq p^{3/2} > 2(p-1)$); so $\kappa_1 = 0$ for $f \geq 3$.

Let $f = 1$, $p = 4k+3$, and $I = \{x : |x| \leq k\} \subset \mathbb{F}_p$, the residues with $\|x/p\| < \frac{1}{4}$. The number of $z \in \mu_{p+1}$ with $\text{Tr}(bz) \in I$ is

$$\frac{(p+1)|I|}{p} + \frac{1}{p} \sum_{a \neq 0} \left(\sum_{x \in I} \psi(-ax) \right) S(ab) \geq \frac{p^2-1}{2p} - \frac{2\sqrt{p}}{p} \sum_{a=1}^{p-1} \frac{1}{|\sin(\pi a/p)|} \geq \frac{p^2-1}{2p} - 2\sqrt{p}(\ln p + 1),$$

because $|\sum_{x \in I} \psi(-ax)| = |\sin(\pi a(2k+1)/p)/\sin(\pi a/p)| \leq 1/|\sin(\pi a/p)|$, and, by the symmetry $a \leftrightarrow p-a$ and $\sin x \geq 2x/\pi$ on $[0, \pi/2]$, $\sum_{a=1}^{p-1} 1/|\sin(\pi a/p)| \leq p \sum_{a \leq (p-1)/2} 1/a \leq p(\ln p + 1)$. The last expression is positive for $p = 1001$ and increasing for $p \geq 1001$ (its derivative is $\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{2p^2} - \frac{\ln p + 3}{\sqrt{p}} > 0$ there). For the primes $p \equiv 3 \pmod{4}$ with $11 \leq p < 3000$ a direct computation (in $\mathbb{F}_{p^2} = \mathbb{F}_p(i)$, where bz runs over the circle $s^2 + t^2 = N(b)$ and $\text{Tr}(bz) = 2s$) gives $\kappa_1 < \frac{1}{4}$; the largest value is $\frac{4}{19}$. For $p = 3$ and $p = 7$ a direct computation gives $\kappa_1 = \frac{1}{3}$ and $\kappa_1 = \frac{2}{7}$, attained by the maps of the proof of Theorem B and of Proposition 3. $\square$

Corollary 5 (local circular values). *Let E be a finite extension of $\mathbb{Q}_p$. If E^2 has a locally constant homomorphism to $K_{P/Q}$ with $P/Q < 4$, then either $p = 2$ and $E(i)/E$ is ramified, or $(p, f) = (3, 1)$ and $P/Q \geq 3$, or $(p, f) = (7, 1)$ and $P/Q \geq 7/2$.*

Proof. If $i \in E$, then $\chi(E^2) = \infty$ [12, Proposition 3]. Otherwise combine Propositions 5 and 6. $\square$

So the restriction to F^2 of a locally constant colouring of a completion F_v^2 of a number field gives, below 4, only the bounds 2 (condition (a)), 3 (condition (b)) and $7/2$ (a place above 7 of residue degree 1).

9. A GAP ABOVE 3

By Corollary 1, $\chi_c(F^2)$ is 2, 3 or larger than 3. Theorem D says that in the last case it stays away from 3. Its proof is that of Theorem B with $I = [1/3, 2/3]$ replaced by a slightly wider interval; the new ingredient is the shape of the characters along the probe for such intervals. The proof is entirely by hand; Section 10 reaches $7/2$ with a second prime and one computer-assisted step.

Notation. In this section $N = 5^k$ with $k \geq 1$, $\rho = (3+4i)/5$, $h = (1+i)/2$ and $\Lambda_\pm = \frac{2 \pm i}{5} \mathbb{Z}[i]$. For $\frac{1}{4} < \theta \leq \frac{1}{3}$ let S_N^θ be defined as S_N with $[\theta, 1-\theta]$ in place of I , and put

$$s = \frac{1}{2} - \theta, \quad \delta = \frac{1}{3} - \theta, \quad B_s = \{a + bi : a, b \in \mathbb{R}, |a|, |b| \leq s\},$$

so that $s = \frac{1}{6} + \delta$, and $P_k = \{x \in \mathbb{C} : \bar{x}\rho^j \in B_s \text{ for } |j| \leq k\}$. For $\varepsilon \in E_q$ and $|j| \leq k$, Lemma 8 below gives $\eta_j^N(\varepsilon) \in \{\pm 1 \pm i\}$ with $\overline{N\varepsilon}\rho^j \in h + \eta_j^N(\varepsilon)/6 + \mathbb{Z}[i]$; for $1 \leq m \leq k$ let

$$Y_m^N(\varepsilon) = \{y \in \mathbb{C} : \eta_j^N(\varepsilon)/6 + \bar{y}\rho^j \in B_s \text{ for } |j| \leq m\},$$

and $Y_k(\varepsilon) = Y_k^N(\varepsilon)$. These depend on θ , on N , and on ε only modulo $\mathbb{Z}[i]$; when N is fixed we write $\eta_j(\varepsilon)$ for $\eta_j^N(\varepsilon)$. We write $w_1 = \operatorname{Re} w$ and $w_2 = \operatorname{Im} w$.

Lemma 8. (i) $G_N = \{i^a \rho^j : a \in \mathbb{Z}, |j| \leq k\}$, and $c \in S_N^\theta$ if and only if $\bar{c}\rho^j \in h + B_s + \mathbb{Z}[i]$ for every $|j| \leq k$.

(ii) If $\varepsilon \in E_c$ and $|j| \leq k$, then $\overline{N\varepsilon}\rho^j \in h + \mathbb{Z}[i]$.

(iii) If $\varepsilon = \frac{\alpha+\beta i}{3} + t \in E_q$ and $|j| \leq k$, then $\overline{N\varepsilon}\rho^j \equiv (-1)^k (-i)^j \frac{\alpha-\beta i}{3} \pmod{\mathbb{Z}[i]}$. This lies in $h + \eta/6 + \mathbb{Z}[i]$ for a unique $\eta \in \{\pm 1 \pm i\}$; moreover $\eta_{j-1}(\varepsilon) = i\eta_j(\varepsilon)$ for $1-k \leq j \leq k$ (so $\eta_{j-2}(\varepsilon) = -\eta_j(\varepsilon)$), and $\eta_j(\bar{\varepsilon}) = \bar{\eta}_{-j}(\varepsilon)$.

(iv) $N\varepsilon + P_k \subseteq S_N^\theta$ for $\varepsilon \in E_c$, and $N\varepsilon + Y_k(\varepsilon) \subseteq S_N^\theta$ for $\varepsilon \in E_q$.

Proof. (i) If $\gamma \in G_N$, then $N\gamma \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$ has norm 5^{2k} , so $N\gamma = u(2+i)^a(2-i)^b$ with a unit u and $a+b=2k$, and $\gamma = u(\frac{2+i}{2-i})^{a-k} = u\rho^{a-k}$; conversely $N\rho^{\pm j} = 5^{k-j}(3 \pm 4i)^j \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$ for $0 \leq j \leq k$. Since $\operatorname{Re}(\pm iw) = \mp \operatorname{Im} w$ and $[\theta, 1-\theta] + \mathbb{Z} = \frac{1}{2} + [-s, s] + \mathbb{Z}$ is symmetric, $\operatorname{Re}(\bar{c}\gamma) \in [\theta, 1-\theta] + \mathbb{Z}$ for all $\gamma \in G_N$ if and only if both coordinates of every $\bar{c}\rho^j$ lie in $\frac{1}{2} + [-s, s] + \mathbb{Z}$.

(ii) Write $\varepsilon = h + t$. The Gaussian integer $N\rho^j$ has odd norm, so $N\rho^j = 1 + (1+i)m$ with $m \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$, and $\bar{h}N\rho^j = \bar{h} + m \equiv h$, as $\bar{h} = h - i$; and $\bar{t}N\rho^j \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$.

(iii) $\overline{N\varepsilon}\rho^j \equiv \frac{\alpha-\beta i}{3} N\rho^j$, and $N\rho^j \equiv (-1)^k (-i)^j \pmod{3}$, because $5 \equiv -1$ and $3 \pm 4i \equiv \pm i \pmod{3}$. Modulo $\mathbb{Z}[i]$, $\frac{\alpha-\beta i}{3}$ times a unit has both coordinates in $\{\frac{1}{3}, \frac{2}{3}\}$, so it lies in $h + \frac{\pm 1 \pm i}{6} + \mathbb{Z}[i]$. Since $(-i)^{j-1} = i(-i)^j$ and $ih \equiv h$, $\eta_{j-1} = i\eta_j$. Finally $\overline{N\varepsilon}\rho^j$ is the conjugate of $\overline{N\varepsilon}\rho^{-j}$, and $\bar{h} \equiv h$.

(iv) follows from (i)–(iii). $\square$

Lemma 9. (i) $P_1 = sP$, where P is the 12-gon with vertices $\pm 1 \pm \frac{i}{3}$, $\pm \frac{1}{3} \pm i$ and $\frac{5}{7}(\pm 1 \pm i)$; so $|x| \leq s\sqrt{10}/3$ for $x \in P_k$.

(ii) $|y| \leq \sqrt{2}\delta$ for $y \in Y_m^N(\varepsilon)$, $1 \leq m \leq k$.

Proof. (i) P_1 is defined by the twelve inequalities $\pm(\bar{x}\rho^j)_e \leq s$, $j \in \{0, \pm 1\}$, $e \in \{1, 2\}$, which are homogeneous in (x, s) ; intersecting their boundary lines in pairs gives the vertices. For instance at $x = 1 + \frac{i}{3}$ we have $\bar{x} = 1 - \frac{i}{3}$, $\bar{x}\rho = \frac{13}{15} + \frac{3}{5}i$ and $\bar{x}\rho^{-1} = \frac{1}{3} - i$. Every vertex has modulus at most $\sqrt{10}/3$, and $P_k \subseteq P_1$.

(ii) As $s = \frac{1}{6} + \delta$, the condition $\eta_j/6 + \bar{y}\rho^j \in B_s$ implies $\eta_{j,e}(\bar{y}\rho^j)_e \leq \delta$ for $e = 1, 2$, where $\eta_j = \eta_{j,1} + \eta_{j,2}i$. So $Y_m^N(\varepsilon) \subseteq Y_1^N(\varepsilon) \subseteq \delta X(\varepsilon)$, where $X(\varepsilon)$ is defined by the six inequalities $\eta_{j,e}(\bar{y}\rho^j)_e \leq 1$, $|j| \leq 1$ (for $\delta = 0$ read $\delta X(\varepsilon)$ as $\{0\}$: as $X(\varepsilon)$ is bounded, the same inequalities with right-hand side 0 have only the solution 0). By Lemma 8(iii), $\eta_j^N(\varepsilon) = \eta_j^5(\pm\varepsilon)$ for $|j| \leq 1$; replacing ε by $i\varepsilon$ replaces η_j by $-i\eta_j$ and X by iX , and multiplication by i permutes the four classes of E_q modulo $\mathbb{Z}[i]$ cyclically. So every $X(\varepsilon)$ is a rotation of $X(\frac{1+i}{3})$ at level 5, where $\eta_{-1} = 1+i$, $\eta_0 = 1-i$, $\eta_1 = -1-i$. This is the hexagon with vertices $-\frac{5}{4}$, $-\frac{5}{4}i$, $-\frac{5}{7}(1+i)$, $1-\frac{i}{2}$, $1+i$ and $-\frac{1}{2}+i$, of moduli at most $\sqrt{2}$. $\square$

Lemma 10. Let $0 < s < 11/56$ and $k \geq 1$, and let $x \in \mathbb{C}$ with $|x| \leq s\sqrt{2}$ and $\bar{x}\rho^{k-2} \in B_s$. Then $\bar{x}\rho^k + \nu \notin B_s + \mathbb{Z}[i]$ for every $\nu \in \Lambda_+ \setminus \mathbb{Z}[i]$. The same holds with ρ^{-k} , ρ^{2-k} and Λ_- in place of ρ^k , ρ^{k-2} and Λ_+ .

Proof. Let $u = \bar{x}\rho^k$ and $w = \bar{x}\rho^{k-2} = u\rho^{-2} = u(-7-24i)/25$, so that $w_1 = (-7u_1 + 24u_2)/25$ and $w_2 = -(24u_1 + 7u_2)/25$. Suppose $u + \nu \in B_s + \mathbb{Z}[i]$; changing ν by a Gaussian integer we may assume $u + \nu \in B_s$. The non-zero classes of $\Lambda_+/\mathbb{Z}[i]$ are represented by $\pm \frac{2+i}{5}$ and $\pm \frac{-1+2i}{5}$, whose coordinates have absolute value at most $\frac{2}{5}$; every other element of the class has a coordinate of absolute value at least $\frac{3}{5}$, which $u_e + \nu_e \in [-s, s]$ excludes, as $|u_e| \leq |x| \leq s\sqrt{2}$ and $s(1+\sqrt{2}) < \frac{3}{5}$. If $\nu = \pm \frac{2+i}{5}$, then $\mp u_1 \geq \frac{2}{5} - s$ and $\mp u_2 \geq \frac{1}{5} - s$, so $\pm w_2 = \mp(24u_1 + 7u_2)/25 \geq (11 - 31s)/25$. If $\nu = \pm \frac{-1+2i}{5}$, then $\pm u_1 \geq \frac{1}{5} - s$ and $\mp u_2 \geq \frac{2}{5} - s$, so $\mp w_1 = \pm(7u_1 - 24u_2)/25 \geq (11 - 31s)/25$. In both cases $|w_e| \geq (11 - 31s)/25 > s$, as $56s < 11$, contradicting $w \in B_s$. The second statement follows by complex conjugation, which exchanges ρ and ρ^{-1} , and Λ_+ and Λ_- , and preserves B_s and $\mathbb{Z}[i]$ (apply the first to $\bar{x}$ and $\bar{\nu}$). $\square$

Lemma 11. *Let $0 \leq \delta < 5/168$, $k \geq 2$ and $\varepsilon \in E_q$, and let $y \in \mathbb{C}$ with $|y| < \frac{1}{6}$ and $\eta_{k-2}(\varepsilon)/6 + \bar{y}\rho^{k-2} \in B_s$. Then $\overline{N\varepsilon + y}\rho^k + \nu \notin h + B_s + \mathbb{Z}[i]$ for every $\nu \in \Lambda_+ \setminus \mathbb{Z}[i]$. The same holds with ρ^{-k} , ρ^{2-k} , $\eta_{2-k}(\varepsilon)$ and Λ_- in place of ρ^k , ρ^{k-2} , $\eta_{k-2}(\varepsilon)$ and Λ_+ .*

Proof. Replacing (ε, y, ν) by $(i\varepsilon, iy, -i\nu)$ multiplies $\overline{N\varepsilon + y}\rho^k + \nu$ by $-i$ and replaces η_j by $-i\eta_j$; it preserves $h + B_s + \mathbb{Z}[i]$ (as $-ih \equiv h$), E_q , Λ_+ and the hypotheses. So we may assume $\eta_k(\varepsilon) = 1 + i$, and then $\eta_{k-2}(\varepsilon) = -1 - i$ (Lemma 8). Let $u = \bar{y}\rho^k$, so that $\bar{y}\rho^{k-2} = u(-7 - 24i)/25$. Suppose the conclusion fails. Then $\frac{1}{6} + \nu_e + u_e \in [-s, s] + \mathbb{Z}$ for $e = 1, 2$, where we take $\nu_e \in \{\pm\frac{1}{5}, \pm\frac{2}{5}\}$. As $|u_e| < \frac{1}{6}$ and $s < \frac{1}{5}$, the values $\nu_e = \frac{1}{5}$ and $\nu_e = \frac{2}{5}$ are impossible ($\frac{1}{6} + \nu_e + u_e$ then lies in $(\frac{1}{5}, \frac{11}{15})$), and $\nu_e = -\frac{2}{5}$ forces $u_e \geq \frac{1}{15} - \delta$. Of the four non-zero classes $\pm(\frac{2}{5}, \frac{1}{5})$, $\pm(-\frac{1}{5}, \frac{2}{5})$ of $\Lambda_+/\mathbb{Z}[i]$ only $\nu = (-\frac{2}{5}, -\frac{1}{5})$ remains, so $u_1 \geq \frac{1}{15} - \delta$. On the other hand the hypothesis at ρ^{k-2} says that both coordinates of $u(-7 - 24i)/25$ are at least $-\delta$: $7u_1 - 24u_2 \leq 25\delta$ and $24u_1 + 7u_2 \leq 25\delta$. Adding 7 times the first to 24 times the second gives $625u_1 \leq 775\delta$, that is $u_1 \leq \frac{31}{25}\delta$. Hence $\frac{1}{15} \leq \frac{56}{25}\delta$, that is $\delta \geq \frac{5}{168}$, a contradiction. The second statement follows by complex conjugation, as in Lemma 10: $\bar{\varepsilon} \in E_q$, $\bar{h} \equiv h$, and $\eta_{k-2}(\bar{\varepsilon}) = \overline{\eta_{2-k}(\varepsilon)}$ by Lemma 8(iii). $\square$

Proposition 7. *Let $17/56 < \theta \leq 1/3$, $k \geq 1$ and $N = 5^k$. Then*

$$S_N^\theta = \bigcup_{\varepsilon \in E_c} (N\varepsilon + P_k) \cup \bigcup_{\varepsilon \in E_q} (N\varepsilon + Y_k(\varepsilon)).$$

In particular every $c \in S_N^\theta$ is $c = N\varepsilon + x$, either with $\varepsilon \in E_c$ and $|x| \leq s\sqrt{10}/3$, or with $\varepsilon \in E_q$ and $|x| \leq \sqrt{2}\delta$.

For $\theta = 1/3$ we have $s\sqrt{10}/3 = \sqrt{10}/18$ and $\delta = 0$, and this is Proposition 1.

Proof. The inclusion $\supseteq$ is Lemma 8(iv). Note that $\theta > 17/56$ means $s < 11/56$ and $\delta < 5/168$, and that then $s(1 + \sqrt{2}) < \frac{3}{5}$. The sets on the right are invariant under $N\mathbb{Z}[i]$ and under multiplication by i (which maps E_c and E_q to themselves modulo $\mathbb{Z}[i]$), and so is S_N^θ . We use induction on k . For $\lambda \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$ put $\nu_\pm(\lambda) = \frac{N}{5}\bar{\lambda}\rho^{\pm k}$. Since $\frac{N}{5}\rho^k = \frac{(2+i)^{2k}}{5} = \frac{(2+i)^{2k-1}}{2-i}$, we have $\nu_\pm(\lambda) \in \Lambda_\pm$, and $\nu_+(\lambda) \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$ if and only if $2+i$ divides λ ; likewise $\nu_-(\lambda) \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$ if and only if $2-i$ divides λ . So both are Gaussian integers if and only if $5 \mid \lambda$.

The case $k = 1$. Let $c \in S_5^\theta$. The condition at ρ^0 gives $c \in h + B_s + \mathbb{Z}[i]$, so $c = 5h + x + \lambda$ with $x \in B_s$ and $\lambda \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$, which we take modulo 5; put $z = \bar{x}$, so $|z| \leq s\sqrt{2}$. By Lemma 8(ii) the conditions at $\rho^{\pm 1}$ read $z\rho^{\pm 1} + \nu_\pm(\lambda) \in B_s + \mathbb{Z}[i]$, and as in the proof of Lemma 10 the shift can be taken to be the representative of $\nu_\pm(\lambda)$ modulo $\mathbb{Z}[i]$ with coordinates in $[-\frac{2}{5}, \frac{2}{5}]$. If both $\nu_\pm(\lambda)$ are Gaussian integers, then $5 \mid \lambda$ and $x \in P_1$ (as $|z\rho^{\pm 1}| \leq s\sqrt{2} < 1 - s$). If exactly one is, say $\nu_-(\lambda)$, then $z\rho^{-1} \in B_s$, and Lemma 10 with $k = 1$ contradicts the condition at ρ ; the other case is symmetric. In the remaining 16 classes, multiplication by i leaves four orbits, represented by $\lambda = 1, 2, 2 + 2i$ and $1 + i$. Write $(z\rho)_{1,2} = \frac{1}{5}(3z_1 - 4z_2, 4z_1 + 3z_2)$ and $(z\rho^{-1})_{1,2} = \frac{1}{5}(3z_1 + 4z_2, -4z_1 + 3z_2)$.

- $\lambda = 1$: $\nu_\pm \equiv \frac{-2 \mp i}{5}$, so $(z\rho)_1, (z\rho^{-1})_1 \geq \frac{2}{5} - s$. Their sum is $\frac{6}{5}z_1 \leq \frac{6}{5}s$, so $\frac{4}{5} - 2s \leq \frac{6}{5}s$ and $s \geq \frac{1}{4}$.
- $\lambda = 2$: $\nu_\pm \equiv \frac{1 \mp 2i}{5}$, so $(z\rho)_1, (z\rho^{-1})_1 \leq s - \frac{1}{5}$ and $(z\rho)_2 \geq \frac{2}{5} - s$. As $7(z\rho)_1 + 25(z\rho^{-1})_1 - 24(z\rho)_2 = 0$, we get $0 \leq 32(s - \frac{1}{5}) + 24(s - \frac{2}{5})$, so $s \geq \frac{2}{7}$.
- $\lambda = 2 + 2i$: $\nu_+ \equiv \frac{-1 + 2i}{5}$ and $\nu_- \equiv \frac{-2 + i}{5}$, so $(z\rho)_2 \leq s - \frac{2}{5}$, $(z\rho^{-1})_1 \geq \frac{2}{5} - s$ and $(z\rho^{-1})_2 \leq s - \frac{1}{5}$. As $25(z\rho)_2 - 24(z\rho^{-1})_1 + 7(z\rho^{-1})_2 = 0$, we get $0 \leq 49(s - \frac{2}{5}) + 7(s - \frac{1}{5})$, so $s \geq \frac{3}{8}$.
- $\lambda = 1 + i$: then $c = 5\varepsilon + y$ with $\varepsilon = \frac{2+2i}{3} \in E_q$ and $y = x + \frac{1+i}{6}$, so $|y| \leq \sqrt{2}(s + \frac{1}{6}) < 0.52$. By Lemma 8(iii), $\bar{c}\rho^j \in h + \eta_j(\varepsilon)/6 + \bar{y}\rho^j + \mathbb{Z}[i]$, and as $|\bar{y}\rho^j| < 0.52$ and $\frac{1}{6} + 0.52 < 1 - s$, the condition at ρ^j says $\eta_j(\varepsilon)/6 + \bar{y}\rho^j \in B_s$. So $y \in Y_1^5(\varepsilon)$.

The first three orbits are thus empty, as $s < 11/56 < \frac{1}{4}$.

The step from $k - 1$ to $k \geq 2$. Let $c \in S_N^\theta$. As $G_{N/5} \subseteq G_N$, $c \in S_{N/5}^\theta$, and by induction $c = \frac{N}{5}\varepsilon' + x$ with $\varepsilon' \in E_c$ and $x \in P_{k-1}$, or with $\varepsilon' \in E_q$ and $x \in Y_{k-1}^{N/5}(\varepsilon')$.

If $\varepsilon' = h + t \in E_c$, then $\frac{N}{5}\varepsilon' = Nh + \frac{N}{5}(t - 2 - 2i)$, so $c = Nh + x + \frac{N}{5}\lambda$ with $\lambda \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$. By Lemma 8(ii) the condition at $\rho^{\pm k}$ reads $\bar{x}\rho^{\pm k} + \nu_{\pm}(\lambda) \in B_s + \mathbb{Z}[i]$. Here $|x| \leq s\sqrt{10}/3 < s\sqrt{2}$ by Lemma 9, and $\bar{x}\rho^{\pm(k-2)} \in B_s$ as $x \in P_{k-1}$. By Lemma 10 both $\nu_{\pm}(\lambda)$ are Gaussian integers, so $5 \mid \lambda$ and $c \in Nh + x + N\mathbb{Z}[i]$; and $\bar{x}\rho^{\pm k} \in B_s + \mathbb{Z}[i]$ with $|x| < 1 - s$ gives $x \in P_k$.

If $\varepsilon' = \frac{\alpha' + \beta'i}{3} + t' \in E_q$, let $\alpha, \beta \in \{1, 2\}$ with $\alpha \equiv 2\alpha' \pmod{3}$ and $\beta \equiv 2\beta' \pmod{3}$, and $\varepsilon = \frac{\alpha + \beta i}{3}$. Then $\frac{N}{5}\varepsilon' - N\varepsilon \in \frac{N}{5}\mathbb{Z}[i]$, because $\alpha' - 5\alpha \equiv \alpha' - 2\alpha \equiv 0 \pmod{3}$, and likewise for β ; so $c = N\varepsilon + x + \frac{N}{5}\lambda$ with $\lambda \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$. For $|j| \leq k - 1$ we have $\frac{N}{5}\rho^j \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$, so $\eta_j^N(\varepsilon) = \eta_j^{N/5}(\varepsilon')$ for $|j| \leq k - 1$, and $x \in Y_{k-1}^N(\varepsilon)$. In particular $|x| \leq \sqrt{2}\delta < \frac{1}{6}$, and the hypotheses of Lemma 11 hold at $\rho^{\pm(k-2)}$. The condition at $\rho^{\pm k}$ says $\overline{N\varepsilon + x}\rho^{\pm k} + \nu_{\pm}(\lambda) \in h + B_s + \mathbb{Z}[i]$, so by Lemma 11 both $\nu_{\pm}(\lambda)$ are Gaussian integers, $5 \mid \lambda$ and $c \in N\varepsilon + x + N\mathbb{Z}[i]$. Finally $\eta_{\pm k}(\varepsilon)/6 + \bar{x}\rho^{\pm k} \in B_s + \mathbb{Z}[i]$ with $|x| < \frac{1}{2}$ gives $x \in Y_k(\varepsilon)$. The bounds on $|x|$ are Lemma 9. $\square$

Proof of Theorem D. Suppose that F^2 has a homomorphism to $K_{p/q}$ with $p/q < 56/17$; we show that $\chi(F^2) \leq 3$. If $i \in F$ this cannot happen, as then $\chi(F^2) = \infty$ (proof of Theorem B). If $p/q \leq 3$, then $\chi(F^2) \leq \chi(K_{p/q}) \leq 3$. Otherwise $\theta = q/p \in (17/56, 1/3)$, and we follow the proof of Lemma 2 for a finite $V \subset T$. Theorem W⁺ applies, as $p < 4q$, and gives a character with $\xi(U) \subseteq [\theta, 1 - \theta] + \mathbb{Z}$; so $\varphi(v) \in S_N^{\theta}$ for $v \in V$, and Proposition 7 writes $\varphi(v) = N\varepsilon_v + x_v$ with $\varepsilon_v \in E$ and $|x_v| \leq r_{\theta} = \max(s\sqrt{10}/3, \sqrt{2}\delta)$ (so $r_{1/3} = r$). Lemma 1 and its proof hold for such points with r_{θ} in place of r . So, choosing $N > 6r_{\theta} \max_v(|D_v| + \sum_j |\mu_{v,j}|)$, we obtain $\beta \in L$ with $\text{Tr}(\beta v) \in E$ for every $v \in V$: the conclusion of Lemma 2. The proof of Lemma 4 uses the 3-colouring only through this conclusion, and the rest of the proof of Theorem B only through (c) or (q). So (a) or (b) holds, and $\chi(F^2) \leq 3$ by Theorem B. Finally, if $\chi(F^2) \geq 4$ and $\chi_c(F^2) < 56/17$, the definition of χ_c as an infimum gives a homomorphism to some $K_{p/q}$ with $p/q < 56/17$, which we have excluded. $\square$

A computer-assisted extension. With exact computations the same method gives $\chi_c(F^2) \geq 10^7/3001611 > 3.3315$ whenever $\chi(F^2) \geq 4$; Theorem E supersedes this, but the computations show where the one-prime probe stops. Let $\theta^* = 0.3001611$. It suffices that for every $k \geq 17$ the conclusion of Proposition 7 holds for θ^* , so that every $c \in S_N^{\theta^*}$ is $N\varepsilon + x$ with $\varepsilon \in E$ and $|x| \leq r_{\theta^*} < 0.22$: then for $p/q < 1/\theta^*$ the argument above applies with $\theta = q/p$, since $S_N^{\theta} \subseteq S_N^{\theta^*}$, with r_{θ^*} in place of r_{θ} and $k \geq 17$. We computed $S_N^{\theta^*}$ exactly, as a finite union of rational polygons modulo N , level by level, with three programs written separately (two of them by referees): all three find the same number of components at every level $k \leq 19$, and only the components of Proposition 7 for $k = 17, 18, 19$. For $k \geq 18$ the induction step of Proposition 7 goes through with Lemmas 10 and 11 replaced by the same statements under the hypotheses $x \in P_{k-1}$, resp. $y \in Y_{k-1}^N(\varepsilon)$, for every shift $\nu \in \Lambda_{\pm} \setminus \mathbb{Z}[i]$ (the programs do not use the reduction to the shifts of the hand proofs). The infimum of the θ for which these statements hold is an exact linear-programming value. It is non-increasing in k : in the coordinates $\bar{x}\rho^k$, resp. $\bar{y}\rho^k$, and since $\eta_{k-m} = i^m \eta_k$ (Lemma 8), the system at level $k + 1$ contains the one at level k . All three programs find that it is at most $0.30005568 < \theta^*$ for $k = 12, 13$ and 14 (two of them up to $k = 22$).

Remark. (1) For a statement valid for every k , the bound $17/56$ in Proposition 7 is best possible: for $\theta = 17/56$, S_N^{θ} has further isolated points for $N = 5, 25, 125$ and 625 (8, 20, 12 and 4 of them modulo $N\mathbb{Z}[i]$), at which $\min_{\gamma} \|\text{Re}(\bar{c}\gamma)\| = 17/56$. But the constant $56/17$ comes from the first levels only: by the same computations, for $\theta > 333/1106$ the set $S_{5^5}^{\theta}$ has only the components of Proposition 7, and the threshold of the induction step is $3303/10981 < 333/1106$ for $4 \leq k \leq 6$, hence at most that for $k \geq 6$; so the levels $k \leq 5$ and the threshold at $k = 6$ already give $\chi_c(F^2) \geq 1106/333 \approx 3.3213$.

(2) The method cannot reach beyond $10/3$. For every k the point $c_k = Nh + \frac{\rho^k}{5} - 5^{k-1}(2-i)$ lies in $S_N^{3/10}$, with $\min_{\gamma} \|\text{Re}(\bar{c}_k\gamma)\| = \frac{3}{10}$: for $-k \leq j < k$, $5^{k-1}(2+i)\rho^j \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$ and $\bar{c}_k\rho^j \equiv h + \rho^{j-k}/5 \pmod{\mathbb{Z}[i]}$, at distance $\frac{1}{5}$ from h ; and $\bar{c}_k\rho^k \equiv h + \frac{1}{5} - \frac{2+i}{5} = h - \frac{1+i}{5}$, because $(2+i)^{2k+1} \equiv 2+i \pmod{5}$. But its distance to NE_c is at least $\sqrt{5} \cdot 5^{k-1} - \frac{1}{5}$, and to NE_q at least $\frac{7}{6} 5^{k-1} - \frac{1}{5}$. So

for $\theta \leq 3/10$ the probe has characters of a third, 5-adic, kind. Section 10 removes them with a rotation whose denominator is a power of another prime.

(3) The least θ above which $S_{5^k}^\theta$ has only the components of Proposition 7 is $17/56$ for $k \leq 4$, $333/1106$ for $k = 5$, $3303/10981$ for $k = 6$ and about 0.30016093 for $k = 17$. We expect that it tends to $3/10$, as do the thresholds of the induction step (about 0.300036 for $20 \leq k \leq 22$); that would give $\chi_c(F^2) \geq 10/3$ by this method.

10. TWO PRIMES

The probe of Section 9 uses only the rotations $i^a \rho^j$, whose denominators are powers of 5, and for $\theta \leq 3/10$ it has characters of a third kind (Remark in Section 9). The plane over a number field contains every rational rotation. We add one with another prime, $\sigma = \frac{3+2i}{3-2i} = \frac{5+12i}{13}$, and for $k, m \geq 0$ put

$$G(k, m) = \{i^a \rho^j \sigma^l : a \in \mathbb{Z}, |j| \leq k, |l| \leq m\},$$

$$S^\theta(k, m) = \{c \in \mathbb{C} : \operatorname{Re}(\bar{c}\gamma) \in [\theta, 1 - \theta] + \mathbb{Z} \text{ for every } \gamma \in G(k, m)\},$$

so that $S^\theta(k, 0) = S_N^\theta$ for $N = 5^k$. We keep the notation of Section 9, with $\frac{1}{4} < \theta \leq \frac{1}{3}$. If $i \notin F$, then $G(k, m) \subset T$: its elements lie in $\mathbb{Q}(i)$ and have norm one, and the automorphism of L/F restricts to complex conjugation on $\mathbb{Q}(i)$.

For $c \in \mathbb{C}$ and $\gamma \in \mathbb{Q}(i)$, the *strip index* of c at γ is $n_\gamma(c) = \lfloor \operatorname{Re}(\bar{c}\gamma) \rfloor$. For $c \in S^\theta(k, m)$ and $\gamma \in G(k, m)$, $\operatorname{Re}(\bar{c}\gamma) \in [n_\gamma(c) + \theta, n_\gamma(c) + 1 - \theta]$, and the *margins* $\operatorname{Re}(\bar{c}\gamma) - n_\gamma(c)$ and $n_\gamma(c) + 1 - \operatorname{Re}(\bar{c}\gamma)$ are at least θ . The points of $S^\theta(k, m)$ with a given vector of strip indices form a compact convex polygon, on which the margins are affine functions; two different vectors give disjoint polygons, as some functional takes its values in two different strips. So the connected components of $S^\theta(k, m)$ correspond to the index vectors that occur, and a point of $S^\theta(k, m)$ lies in $S^{\theta'}(k, m)$ for $\theta' < \theta$, with the same strip indices. As $65\gamma \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$ for $\gamma \in G(1, 1)$, $S^\theta(1, 1)$ is invariant under translation by $65\mathbb{Z}[i]$; its *type points* are $65h$ and $\frac{65}{3}(\alpha + \beta i)$, $\alpha, \beta \in \{1, 2\}$.

Proposition 8 (computer-assisted). *Let $\frac{2}{7} < \theta \leq \frac{1}{3}$ and $c \in S^\theta(1, 1)$. Then there are a type point c_0 and $m \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$ such that c and $c_0 + 65m$ have the same strip index at every $\gamma \in G(1, 1)$.*

Proof. Let $r_0 = \frac{7}{25} < \frac{2}{7}$; then $S^\theta(1, 1) \subseteq S^{r_0}(1, 1)$. As $\operatorname{Re}(\bar{c} \cdot i\gamma) = -\operatorname{Im}(\bar{c}\gamma)$ and $[\theta, 1 - \theta] + \mathbb{Z}$ is symmetric, only the 18 functionals $\operatorname{Re}(\bar{c}\gamma)$ and $\operatorname{Im}(\bar{c}\gamma)$ with $\gamma = \rho^j \sigma^l$, $|j|, |l| \leq 1$, matter. The proof is a finite computation with exact certificates of two kinds (Section 11).

Completeness. After a translation by $65\mathbb{Z}[i]$, c lies in a cell $[a + r_0, a + 1 - r_0] \times [b + r_0, b + 1 - r_0]$ with $0 \leq a, b \leq 64$, which fixes the strip indices at $\gamma = 1$ and $\gamma = -i$. For each of the other 16 functionals, in a fixed order, the possible strip indices are the integers n for which $[n + r_0, n + 1 - r_0]$ meets the range of the functional on the cell. A tree lists, for each cell and each branch, every possible index either as a branch to follow or as closed; a closed branch carries a Farkas certificate: three inequalities valid on the branch (sides of the cell, and sides of the strips chosen so far) and rational multipliers $\lambda \geq 0$ whose combination reads $0 \leq -\epsilon$ for some rational $\epsilon > 0$. The open branches end in 13 leaves (15 620 branch nodes, 4 364 closed branches), so every $c \in S^{r_0}(1, 1)$ has, up to $65\mathbb{Z}[i]$, one of 13 explicit index vectors.

The 13 vectors. Five are those of the type points. Each of the other eight comes with three of its margins μ_1, μ_2, μ_3 and rationals $\lambda_1, \lambda_2, \lambda_3 \geq 0$ with $\sum \lambda_i = 1$ and $\sum \lambda_i \mu_i = \frac{2}{7}$ identically (the linear parts cancel). At a point of $S^\theta(1, 1)$ every margin is at least $\theta > \frac{2}{7}$, so no such point has one of these eight vectors. $\square$

The eight vectors excluded at the end are those of the 7-torsion points $\frac{65}{7}(a + bi)$ with $(a, b) \in \{(1, 2), (1, 5), (2, 1), (2, 6), (5, 1), (5, 6), (6, 2), (6, 5)\}$, at which the least margin is exactly $\frac{2}{7}$. They are the characters of the 7-adic colourings of Proposition 3 (the map $\lambda(a + bi) = 2a + 3b$ gives $\frac{65}{7}(1 + 5i)$), and as they are characters of all of $\mathbb{Q}(i)$, the bound $\frac{2}{7}$ is optimal for every finite set of rotations. Both primes are needed, and so are the mixed rotations: with the primes 13 and 17 the corresponding window keeps 12 other components above $\frac{2}{7}$ (some with largest least

margin $\frac{2}{5}$), and the rotations $1, \rho^{\pm 1}, \sigma^{\pm 1}$ alone keep 180 other components (some with largest least margin $\frac{55}{144} > \frac{1}{3}$); the primes 5 and 17 work as well as 5 and 13.

Lemma 12. *Let $\frac{2}{7} < \theta \leq \frac{1}{3}$, $k \geq 1$, $N = 5^k$, and let $C \in \mathbb{C}$ satisfy $\operatorname{Re}(\bar{C}\gamma) \in [\theta, 1 - \theta] + \mathbb{Z}$ for every $\gamma \in G(k, 1)$. Then $C \in N\varepsilon + P_k + N\mathbb{Z}[i]$ for some $\varepsilon \in E_c$, or $C \in N\varepsilon + Y_k(\varepsilon) + N\mathbb{Z}[i]$ for some $\varepsilon \in E_q$. In particular $C = N\varepsilon + x$ with $\varepsilon \in E$ and $|x| \leq r_\theta = \max(s\sqrt{10}/3, \sqrt{2}\delta) < 0.23$.*

Proof. Digits. For $|j| \leq k$ the conditions at ρ^j and $-i\rho^j$ say that both coordinates of $\bar{C}\rho^j$ lie in $\frac{1}{2} + [-s, s] + \mathbb{Z}$, so $\bar{C}\rho^j = h + g_j + n_j$ with $g_j \in B_s$ and $n_j \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$, unique as $s < \frac{1}{2}$; here $n_j = n_{\rho^j}(C) + i n_{-i\rho^j}(C)$. For $-k < j \leq k$ let $\nu_j = g_j - \rho g_{j-1}$. As $\bar{C}\rho^j = \rho \cdot \bar{C}\rho^{j-1}$,

$$\nu_j = (\rho - 1)h + \rho n_{j-1} - n_j,$$

so ν_j depends only on the strip indices of C at ρ^{j-1} , $-i\rho^{j-1}$, ρ^j and $-i\rho^j$. For any $c \in \mathbb{C}$ we define $n_t(c) = n_{\rho^t}(c) + i n_{-i\rho^t}(c)$, $g_t(c) = \bar{c}\rho^t - h - n_t(c)$ and $\nu_t(c) = g_t(c) - \rho g_{t-1}(c) = (\rho - 1)h + \rho n_{t-1}(c) - n_t(c)$ in the same way.

Type points. Let $m \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$ and $|t| \leq 1$. If $c_0 = 65h$, then $65\rho^t$ is a Gaussian integer of odd norm, so $c_0 + 65m\rho^t \equiv h \pmod{\mathbb{Z}[i]}$, as in Lemma 8(ii), and $\nu_0 = \nu_1 = 0$ at $c_0 + 65m$. If $c_0 = \frac{65}{3}(\alpha + \beta i)$, then $c_0 + 65m\rho^t \equiv \frac{\alpha - \beta i}{3}u_t \pmod{\mathbb{Z}[i]}$ with $u_t \equiv 65\rho^t \equiv -(-i)^t \pmod{3}$, as $65 \equiv -1$ and $\rho \equiv -i \pmod{3}$. So $g_t = \eta_t/6$ at $c_0 + 65m$, with $\eta_t \in \{\pm 1 \pm i\}$ and $\eta_{t+1} = -i\eta_t$ (as $-ih \equiv h$), and

$$\nu_t = \frac{\eta_t - \rho\eta_{t-1}}{6} = -\frac{(i + \rho)\eta_{t-1}}{6} = -\frac{1 + 3i}{10}\eta_{t-1} \neq 0, \quad \nu_1 = -i\nu_0.$$

Windows. Let $-k < j < k$ and $c = \rho^{-j}C$, so that $\bar{c} = \rho^j\bar{C}$. For $\gamma \in G(1, 1)$ we have $\rho^j\gamma \in G(k, 1)$, so $c \in S^\theta(1, 1)$, and by Proposition 8 c has the strip indices of some $c_0 + 65m$. The strip indices of c at ρ^t and $-i\rho^t$ are those of C at ρ^{j+t} and $-i\rho^{j+t}$; so $(\nu_j, \nu_{j+1}) = (\nu_0(c_0 + 65m), \nu_1(c_0 + 65m))$, which is $(0, 0)$ or $(\nu, -i\nu)$ with $\nu = -\frac{1+3i}{10}\eta$, $\eta \in \{\pm 1 \pm i\}$.

Pure words. The pairs (ν_j, ν_{j+1}) , $-k < j < k$, cover $\nu_{1-k}, \dots, \nu_k$, and consecutive pairs share a digit. So either all ν_j vanish, or none does and $\nu_{j+1} = -i\nu_j$ for $1 - k \leq j < k$.

Identification. If all digits vanish, then $g_j = \rho^j g_0$ for $|j| \leq k$. Let $x = \bar{g}_0$; then $\bar{x}\rho^j = g_j \in B_s$, so $x \in P_k$, and $\bar{C}\rho^j \equiv h + \bar{x}\rho^j \equiv \bar{N}h + x\rho^j \pmod{\mathbb{Z}[i]}$ by Lemma 8(ii). Hence $\operatorname{Re}(\bar{w}\gamma) \in \mathbb{Z}$ for $w = C - N\bar{h} - x$ and every γ in G_N , so for every γ in the $\mathbb{Z}$ -span of G_N . This span is $\frac{1}{N}\mathbb{Z}[i]$: it is a $\mathbb{Z}[i]$ -module, it contains $\rho^{\pm k} = (2 \pm i)^{2k}/N$, and $(2 + i)^{2k}$ and $(2 - i)^{2k}$ are coprime. With $\gamma = \frac{1}{N}$ and $\frac{i}{N}$ we get $w \in N\mathbb{Z}[i]$.

Otherwise let $\eta_{j-1} = -10\nu_j/(1 + 3i)$ for $1 - k \leq j \leq k$, and $\eta_k = -i\eta_{k-1}$. By the windows these lie in $\{\pm 1 \pm i\}$, and $\eta_j = -i\eta_{j-1}$; so $\nu_j = (\eta_j - \rho\eta_{j-1})/6$, as above, and $g_j - \eta_j/6 = \rho(g_{j-1} - \eta_{j-1}/6)$. Let $y = \bar{g}_0 - \eta_0/6$; then $g_j = \eta_j/6 + \bar{y}\rho^j$ for $|j| \leq k$. Choose $\varepsilon \in E_q$ with $\eta_0(\varepsilon) = \eta_0$; the four classes of E_q give the four values, by Lemma 8(iii). As also $\eta_{j+1}(\varepsilon) = -i\eta_j(\varepsilon)$, we get $\eta_j(\varepsilon) = \eta_j$ for $|j| \leq k$. So $y \in Y_k(\varepsilon)$, and $\bar{C}\rho^j \equiv h + \eta_j/6 + \bar{y}\rho^j \equiv N\varepsilon + \bar{y}\rho^j \pmod{\mathbb{Z}[i]}$; as before, $C - N\varepsilon - y \in N\mathbb{Z}[i]$.

The bounds are Lemma 9, whose proof holds for every $\theta \in (\frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{3}]$; as $s < \frac{3}{14}$ and $\delta < \frac{1}{21}$, $r_\theta < 0.23$. $\square$

Proof of Theorem E. Suppose that F^2 has a homomorphism to $K_{p/q}$ with $p/q < 7/2$; we show that $\chi(F^2) \leq 3$. As in the proof of Theorem D, we may assume that $i \notin F$ and $\theta = q/p \in (\frac{2}{7}, \frac{1}{3})$; and $p < 4q$. Let $V \subset T$ be finite and contain a $\mathbb{Q}(i)$ -basis $b_1, \dots, b_n$ of L , write $D_v v = \sum_j \mu_{v,j} b_j$ as in the proof of Lemma 2, and choose $N = 5^k > 6r_\theta \max_v(|D_v| + \sum_j |\mu_{v,j}|)$. Take $U = G(k, 1)V$ in place of $G_N V$: it is finite, symmetric and consists of unit vectors, so Theorem W⁺ gives a character ξ of $\mathbb{Z}U$ with $\xi(U) \subseteq [\theta, 1 - \theta] + \mathbb{Z}$, and the proof of Lemma 2 gives a $\mathbb{Q}(i)$ -linear map $\varphi : L \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ with $\xi(\gamma v) = \operatorname{Re}(\gamma \varphi(v))$ for $v \in V$ and $\gamma \in G(k, 1)$. So $C = \overline{\varphi(v)}$ satisfies the hypothesis of Lemma 12, and $\varphi(v) = N\varepsilon_v + x_v$ with $\varepsilon_v \in E$ (which is closed under conjugation) and $|x_v| \leq r_\theta$. As in the proof of Theorem D, Lemma 1 with r_θ in place of r gives the conclusion of Lemma 2, and the rest of the proof of Theorem B gives (a) or (b); so $\chi(F^2) \leq 3$.

If $\chi(F^2) \geq 4$ and $\chi_c(F^2) < 7/2$, then F^2 has a homomorphism to some $K_{p/q}$ with $p/q < 7/2$, which we have excluded. So $\chi_c(F^2) \geq 7/2$ when $\chi(F^2) \geq 4$; with Corollary 1, $\chi_c(F^2) \in \{2, 3\} \cup [7/2, \infty]$, and the value $7/2$ is attained by Theorem C. $\square$

With [11, Theorem 1], Theorem E gives the lower bounds of Theorem C again; the certificates of Theorem C show more, namely that 70 explicit unit vectors suffice.

The places above 7. Let $\mathbb{F}_{49} = \mathbb{Z}[i]/7$, let $\mu_8 \subset \mathbb{F}_{49}$ be the group of elements of norm one, which are the residues of the rational rotations ($\rho \equiv 2 + 5i$ has order 8, and $\rho^2 \equiv -i$), and let

$$A'_7 = \{e \in \mathbb{F}_{49} : \operatorname{Re}(\bar{e}z) \in \{2, 3, 4, 5\} \text{ for every } z \in \mu_8\},$$

where $\operatorname{Re}(a + bi) = a$ for $a, b \in \mathbb{F}_7$. Elements of $E_7 = \{\varepsilon \in \frac{1}{7}\mathbb{Z}[i] : 7\varepsilon \bmod 7 \in A'_7\}$ have type 7; let $E' = E \cup E_7$, so that $42E' \subseteq \mathbb{Z}[i]$. For $\varepsilon \in E_7$ the character $a \mapsto \operatorname{Re}(\bar{\varepsilon}a)$ of $\mathbb{Z}_{(7)}[i]$ takes values in $\frac{1}{7}\{2, 3, 4, 5\} + \mathbb{Z}$ at every rational rotation: these are the characters of the 7-adic colourings of Proposition 3. Let $\tilde{\rho} = 2 + 5i$, and for $j \in \mathbb{Z}$ let $\zeta_j(\varepsilon) \in \{\pm\frac{1}{14}, \pm\frac{3}{14}\}^2$ be given by $\bar{\varepsilon}\tilde{\rho}^j \in h + \zeta_j(\varepsilon) + \mathbb{Z}[i]$ (with $\tilde{\rho}^j$ for $j < 0$ read through $\tilde{\rho}^8 \equiv 1 \pmod{7}$).

Lemma 13. (i) $A'_7 = \{a + bi : (a, b) \in \{(2, 3), (2, 4), (3, 2), (3, 5), (4, 2), (4, 5), (5, 3), (5, 4)\}\}$. It is a single μ_8 -orbit, it is closed under conjugation, its elements add up to 0, and $0 \notin A'_7$.

(ii) A'_7 contains no coset of a nonzero additive subgroup of $\mathbb{F}_{49}$.

(iii) $\operatorname{Re}(A'_7) = \{2, 3, 4, 5\}$.

(iv) For $\varepsilon \in E_7$ the digits $\zeta_j(\varepsilon) - \rho\zeta_{j-1}(\varepsilon)$ form a sequence of period 8 in which the digit 0 alternates with digits $u\frac{2+i}{5}$, $u \in \mu_4$; the eight classes of E_7 modulo $\mathbb{Z}[i]$ give its eight shifts. Two consecutive digits of a sequence of type c (all digits 0), q (the digits of the proof of Lemma 12, all nonzero) or 7 determine its type and its shift.

Proof. A direct computation in $\mathbb{F}_{49}$ (two programs written separately; Section 11). $\square$

Let $N_0 = 5^2 \cdot 13 = 325$. The set $S^\theta(2, 1)$ is invariant under $325\mathbb{Z}[i]$, and its type points are $325h$ (type c), $\frac{325}{3}(\alpha + \beta i)$ with $\alpha, \beta \in \{1, 2\}$ (type q), and the eight points $\frac{325}{7}(a + bi)$, $0 \leq a, b \leq 6$, with $3(a + bi) \bmod 7 \in A'_7$ (type 7). As $325 \equiv 3 \pmod{7}$, a point of type 7 has at ρ^t , $|t| \leq 2$, the values of the character of an element of E_7 ; its least margin is $\frac{2}{7}$. Strip indices are floors, so they are defined at these points also for $\theta > \frac{2}{7}$.

Proposition 9 (computer-assisted). Let $\frac{1}{4} < \theta \leq \frac{1}{3}$ and $c \in S^\theta(2, 1)$. Then there are a type point c_0 , of type c , q or 7, and $m \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$ such that c and $c_0 + 325m$ have the same strip index at every $\gamma \in G(2, 1)$.

Proof. As for Proposition 8, with $r_0 = \frac{249}{1000} < \frac{1}{4}$ and the 30 functionals of the 15 rotations $\rho^j \sigma^l$, $|j| \leq 2$, $|l| \leq 1$: the tree over the 325^2 cells has 550 474 branch nodes, 199 920 closed branches and 29 leaves. Of the 29 index vectors, five are those of the points of type c and q , eight those of the points of type 7, and each of the other 16 has a certificate $\lambda \geq 0$, $\sum \lambda_i = 1$, $\sum \lambda_i \mu_i = \frac{1}{4}$ on three margins, which excludes it for $\theta > \frac{1}{4}$. $\square$

The 16 excluded vectors are 2-adic: their largest least margin $\frac{1}{4}$ is attained at 4- and 8-torsion points such as $\frac{325}{4}(1 + i)$ and $\frac{325}{8}(2 + i)$. So $\frac{1}{4}$ is a limit of the method, consistent with $\chi_c(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{59})^2) = 4$. The window $G(1, 1)$ does not suffice below $\frac{2}{7}$: for $\theta = 0.2501$ it has other components, with largest least margins $\frac{11}{42}$ and $\frac{25}{96}$.

Lemma 14. Let $\frac{1}{4} < \theta \leq \frac{1}{3}$, $k \geq 1$ with $6 \mid k$ (so that $N = 5^k \equiv 1 \pmod{7}$), and let $C \in \mathbb{C}$ satisfy $\operatorname{Re}(\bar{C}\gamma) \in [\theta, 1 - \theta] + \mathbb{Z}$ for every $\gamma \in G(k, 1)$. Then C is as in the conclusion of Lemma 12, or $C \in N\varepsilon + X_k(\varepsilon) + N\mathbb{Z}[i]$ for some $\varepsilon \in E_7$, where

$$X_k(\varepsilon) = \{x \in \mathbb{C} : \zeta_j(\varepsilon) + \bar{x}\rho^j \in B_s \text{ for } |j| \leq k\}.$$

In every case $C = N\varepsilon + x$ with $\varepsilon \in E'$ and $|x| \leq r' = (\frac{1}{4} + \frac{3}{14})\sqrt{2} < 0.66$.

Proof. Define g_j, n_j and the digits ν_j as in the proof of Lemma 12. For $|j| \leq k-2$ the point $c = \rho^{-j}C$ lies in $S^\theta(2, 1)$, as $\rho^j G(2, 1) \subseteq G(k, 1)$; by Proposition 9 the digits $\nu_{j-1}, \nu_j, \nu_{j+1}, \nu_{j+2}$ of C are those of a type point at $t = -1, 0, 1, 2$. These are 0 for type c, as $325\rho^t \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$ has odd norm; $(\nu, -i\nu, -\nu, i\nu)$ with $\nu \neq 0$ for type q, as in the proof of Lemma 12, now with $325 \equiv 1 \pmod{3}$; and four consecutive digits of the sequence of Lemma 13(iv) for type 7, as the values of such a point at ρ^t are those of a character of type 7. The windows cover $\nu_{1-k}, \dots, \nu_k$, and consecutive windows share three digits. By Lemma 13(iv), all digits of C are of one type: all 0, all of type q, or $2k$ consecutive digits of the sequence of one class $\varepsilon \in E_7$. In the first two cases the identification is that of Lemma 12. In the third, $N\rho^j \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$ and $N\rho^j \equiv \tilde{\rho}^j \pmod{7}$ for $|j| \leq k$, as $N \equiv 1 \pmod{7}$; so $\overline{N\varepsilon}\rho^j = \bar{\varepsilon}N\rho^j \in h + \zeta_j(\varepsilon) + \mathbb{Z}[i]$. The digits of C are $\zeta_j(\varepsilon) - \rho\zeta_{j-1}(\varepsilon)$, so $g_j - \zeta_j(\varepsilon) = \rho(g_{j-1} - \zeta_{j-1}(\varepsilon))$, and with $x = g_0 - \zeta_0(\varepsilon)$ we get $g_j = \zeta_j(\varepsilon) + \bar{x}\rho^j$ for $|j| \leq k$. So $x \in X_k(\varepsilon)$, $\bar{C}\rho^j \equiv \overline{N\varepsilon} + x\rho^j \pmod{\mathbb{Z}[i]}$, and $C - N\varepsilon - x \in N\mathbb{Z}[i]$ as before. Finally $|x|$ is at most $s\sqrt{10}/3, \sqrt{2}\delta$, resp. $|g_0| + |\zeta_0(\varepsilon)| \leq \sqrt{2}(s + \frac{3}{14})$, each less than r' as $s < \frac{1}{4}$. $\square$

Lemma 15. *Let F be a number field with $i \notin F$, and suppose that F^2 has a homomorphism to $K_{p/q}$ with $3 \leq p/q < 4$. Then for every finite $V \subset T$ there is $\beta \in L$ with $\text{Tr}(\beta v) \in E'$ for every $v \in V$.*

Proof. As in the proof of Theorem E, with $\theta = q/p \in (\frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{3}]$, $6 \mid k$, $N > 42r' \max_v(|D_v| + \sum_j |\mu_{v,j}|)$ and Lemma 14 in place of Lemma 12; E' is closed under conjugation by Lemma 13(i), and Lemma 1 holds with 42 in place of 6, as its proof uses only $42E' \subseteq \mathbb{Z}[i]$ and the bound on $|x|$. $\square$

Let $L_7 = L \otimes_{\mathbb{Q}} \mathbb{Q}_7 = \prod_{u|7} L_u$ and $T_7 = \prod_{u|7} T(F_u)$. As 7 is inert in $\mathbb{Q}(i)$, $\mathbb{Q}(i) \otimes \mathbb{Q}_7 = \mathbb{Q}_{49}$, the unramified quadratic extension of $\mathbb{Q}_7$, and the trace extends to $\text{Tr} : L_7 \rightarrow \mathbb{Q}_{49}$. Let $O_7 = \mathbb{Z}_{49}$ and $\mathcal{A}_7 = \{\frac{e}{7} : e \in O_7, e \bmod 7 \in A'_7\}$; then $E \subseteq O_7$ and $E_7 \subseteq O_2 \cap O_3 \cap \mathcal{A}_7$.

Lemma 16. *Under the hypotheses of Lemma 15, (c) or (q) of Lemma 4 holds, or*

(7') there is $\beta_7 \in L_7$ with $\text{Tr}(\beta_7 z) \in \mathcal{A}_7$ for every $z \in T_7$.

Proof. As the proof of Lemma 4, with a third prime. Let $K_7 = \{\beta \in L_7 : \text{Tr}(\beta b_j) \in \frac{1}{7}O_7 \forall j\}$, which is compact. On $\{c, q, 7\}^T \times K_2 \times K_3 \times K_7$ let $P_v(\tau, \beta_2, \beta_3, \beta_7)$ be the condition

$$\begin{aligned} \tau(v) = c, \quad v_{1+i}(\text{Tr}(\beta_2 v)) &= -1, \quad \text{Tr}(\beta_3 v) \in O_3, \quad \text{Tr}(\beta_7 v) \in O_7; \text{ or} \\ \tau(v) = q, \quad \text{Tr}(\beta_2 v) \in O_2, \quad \text{Tr}(\beta_3 v) \in \mathcal{A}, \quad \text{Tr}(\beta_7 v) \in O_7; \text{ or} \\ \tau(v) = 7, \quad \text{Tr}(\beta_2 v) \in O_2, \quad \text{Tr}(\beta_3 v) \in O_3, \quad \text{Tr}(\beta_7 v) \in \mathcal{A}_7. \end{aligned}$$

These conditions are clopen, Lemma 15 and the local properties of E_c, E_q and E_7 give the finite intersection property, and so some $(\tau, \beta_2, \beta_3, \beta_7)$ satisfies P_v for every $v \in T$. With a, a', b, b' as in the proof of Lemma 4, let $d(x)$ and $d'(x)$, for $x \in T_7$, be the statements $\text{Tr}(\beta_7 x) \in O_7$ and $\text{Tr}(\beta_7 x) \in \mathcal{A}_7$; they exclude each other, as $0 \notin \mathcal{A}'_7$. The set of $(z, y, x) \in T_2 \times T_3 \times T_7$ with $(a(z) \wedge b(y) \wedge d(x)) \vee (a'(z) \wedge b'(y) \wedge d(x)) \vee (a'(z) \wedge b(y) \wedge d'(x))$ is clopen and contains the diagonal image of T , which is dense by Lemma 3; so it is everything. If $a(z_0)$ holds for some z_0 , then b and d hold everywhere, so b' and d' hold nowhere, and a holds everywhere: this is (c). Otherwise a' holds everywhere. If $b'(y_0)$ holds for some y_0 , then d holds everywhere, so d' holds nowhere, and b' holds everywhere: this is (q). Otherwise b holds everywhere, and then d' holds everywhere: this is (7'). $\square$

In case (7') let u be a place of F above 7, f its residue degree, $q = 7^f$, and $g_u(z) = \text{Tr}_{L_u/\mathbb{Q}_{49}}(\beta_u z)$, where $\beta_7 = (\beta_u)_u$; then $\text{Tr}(\beta_7 y) = \sum_u g_u(y_u)$ for $y \in T_7$. If f is even, then $i \in F_u$ and $g_u = 0$, exactly as for even f in Section 5 (with 7^m in place of 3^m). If f is odd, $L_u = F_u(i) = F_u\mathbb{Q}_{49}$ is a field, unramified of degree 2 over F_u , with residue field $\mathbb{F}_{q^2}$; its non-trivial automorphism acts on $\mathbb{Q}_{49}$ as the Frobenius; $T(F_u)$ lies in $O_{L_u}^\times$, contains the Teichmüller lifts of μ_{q+1} , among them $\mu_8 \subset \mathbb{Q}_{49}$ (as $8 \mid q+1$), and reduces onto μ_{q+1} ; and $g_u(\zeta z) = \zeta g_u(z)$ for $\zeta \in \mu_8$.

Lemma 17 (one place). *In case (7') there are a place $u_0 \mid 7$ of odd residue degree and $\beta \in L_{u_0}$ with $\text{Tr}_{L_{u_0}/\mathbb{Q}_{49}}(\beta z) \in \mathcal{A}_7$ for every $z \in T(F_{u_0})$.*

Proof. As the proof of Lemma 5. For a place u of odd residue degree and $z, z' \in T(F_u)$, varying y_u alone gives $g_u(z) - g_u(z') \in \mathcal{A}_7 - \mathcal{A}_7 \subseteq \frac{1}{7}O_7$; with $z' = 1$ and $z = i$, as $i - 1$ is a unit at 7, $g_u(T(F_u)) \subseteq \frac{1}{7}O_7$. Let $Z_u \subseteq \mathbb{F}_{49}$ be the set of residues of $7g_u(z)$, $z \in T(F_u)$; it is stable under μ_8 , and $\sum_u z_u \in A'_7$ for every choice of $z_u \in Z_u$. Suppose two places $u \neq u'$ had nonzero elements $w \in Z_u$ and $w' \in Z_{u'}$. Fix $z_{u''} \in Z_{u''}$ at the other places and put $c = \zeta'w' + \sum z_{u''}$ with $\zeta' \in \mu_8$. The eight distinct elements $c + \zeta w$, $\zeta \in \mu_8$, lie in A'_7 , which has eight elements; so they are all of A'_7 , and summing them gives $8c = c = \sum A'_7 = 0$ (Lemma 13(i)). As this holds for every $\zeta' \in \mu_8$, $w' = 0$: a contradiction. Since $0 \notin A'_7$, exactly one place u_0 has $Z_{u_0} \neq \{0\}$, and it has odd residue degree; the other g_u take values in O_7 , and $\beta = \beta_{u_0}$ works, because $\mathcal{A}_7 + O_7 = \mathcal{A}_7$. $\square$

Lemma 18 (level one). *Let $u \mid 7$ have odd residue degree f , $q = 7^f$, and let $\beta \in L_u$ satisfy $\text{Tr}_{L_u/\mathbb{Q}_{49}}(\beta z) \in \mathcal{A}_7$ for every $z \in T(F_u)$. Then $\lambda(x) = 7 \text{Tr}_{L_u/\mathbb{Q}_{49}}(\beta x) \bmod 7$ is defined on O_{L_u} and vanishes on its maximal ideal, and the induced $\mathbb{F}_{49}$ -linear map $\lambda_1 : \mathbb{F}_{q^2} \rightarrow \mathbb{F}_{49}$ satisfies $\lambda_1(\mu_{q+1}) \subseteq A'_7$.*

Proof. The proof of Lemma 6 applies with 7, $\mathbb{Q}_{49}$, $\mathbb{F}_{49}$ and A'_7 in place of 3, $\mathbb{Q}_9$, $\mathbb{F}_9$ and A' : it uses that the prime is odd, that the order of 7 modulo $q + 1$ is $2f$, and, at the end, Lemma 13(ii) in place of the fact that A' contains no coset of a nonzero subgroup of $\mathbb{F}_9$. $\square$

Lemma 19 (residue fields). *Let f be odd and $q = 7^f$. If some $\mathbb{F}_{49}$ -linear map $\lambda_1 : \mathbb{F}_{q^2} \rightarrow \mathbb{F}_{49}$ satisfies $\lambda_1(\mu_{q+1}) \subseteq A'_7$, then $f = 1$.*

Proof. By Lemma 13(iii), $\text{Re} \circ \lambda_1 : \mathbb{F}_{q^2} \rightarrow \mathbb{F}_7$ is additive and takes values in $\{2, 3, 4, 5\}$ on μ_{q+1} ; read in $\frac{1}{7}\mathbb{Z}/\mathbb{Z}$, it stays at distance at least $\frac{2}{7}$ from 0 there. So $\kappa_1 > 0$ for the unramified extension of $\mathbb{Q}_7$ of degree f , and Proposition 6 gives $f = 1$. $\square$

Proof of Theorem F. If (a) holds, $\chi_c(F^2) = \chi(F^2) = 2$. If (b) holds and (a) fails, $\chi(F^2) = 3$ by Theorem B, so $\chi_c(F^2) = 3$ by Corollary 1. If (7) holds and (a), (b) fail, $\chi(F^2) \geq 4$ by Theorem B, so $\chi_c(F^2) \geq 7/2$ by Theorem E, and $\chi_c(F^2) \leq 7/2$ by Proposition 3, as a place above 7 of residue degree 1 has residue field $\mathbb{F}_7$.

It remains to show that if F^2 has a homomorphism to $K_{p/q}$ with $p/q < 4$, then (a), (b) or (7) holds; then $\chi_c(F^2) \geq 4$ when all three fail. If $i \in F$ there is no such homomorphism, as $\chi(F^2) = \infty$. If $p/q \leq 3$, then $\chi(F^2) \leq 3$, and (a) or (b) holds by Theorem B. Otherwise $3 < p/q < 4$, and by Lemmas 15 and 16 we are in case (c), (q) or (7'). Cases (c) and (q) give (a) or (b) as in the proof of Theorem B. In case (7'), Lemmas 17, 18 and 19 give a place above 7 of residue degree 1: this is (7). $\square$

Remark. (1) Theorem E also follows from Proposition 9: the eight index vectors of type 7 have largest least margin exactly $\frac{2}{7}$, so for $\theta > \frac{2}{7}$ only types c and q remain, and Lemma 14 gives the conclusion of Lemma 2. So Theorem E has two computer-assisted proofs, through different sets of rotations.

(2) A second prime is needed. Besides the 5-adic points of the Remark in Section 9, the one-prime probe has torsion characters $a \mapsto \text{Re}(\bar{c}\tilde{a})$ of $\mathbb{Z}[\frac{1}{5}][i]$, where $c \in \frac{1}{M}\mathbb{Z}[i]$, $5 \nmid M$, and $\tilde{a}$ is the residue of a modulo M . For $M \leq 400$, those other than the characters of type c and q that keep every $i^\alpha \rho^j$ at margin greater than $\frac{2}{7}$ have order 41 (largest least margin $\frac{12}{41}$, at $c = \frac{12+12i}{41}$; ρ has order 5 modulo 41) or 76 (largest least margin $\frac{11}{38}$). For $M \leq 400$ prime to 65, none of them keeps every element of $\langle i, \rho, \sigma \rangle$ at margin greater than $\frac{2}{7}$; and for $k \leq 5$ every translate $c_k + Nm$ of the points c_k of that Remark has least margin at most $\frac{41}{250}$ on $G(k, 1)$.

11. COMPUTER CHECKS

The programs are in the folders `data/number_fields/three_colours/` and `data/number_fields/circular/` of [9], with tests in `tests/test_three_colours.py`.

Lemma 2 as a test. For a finite V , the possible values $z = 6\varphi(v)$ form the lattice $\mathcal{M} = (\text{column space}) \cap \mathbb{Z}^{2m}$, and the types are conditions on z modulo 2 and 3; a program enumerates $\mathcal{M}/2\mathcal{M} \times \mathcal{M}/3\mathcal{M}$ and decides whether some β exists. A second implementation in PARI/GP [20] uses another lattice routine, and a referee wrote a third, which agreed on all 78 of its trials.

The real quadratic cases of [11] come out infeasible; $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{3})$ and $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{7})$ stay feasible; $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{7})$ is infeasible already with five vectors, $1, (7 + 4\sqrt{2}i)/9, (23 + 10\sqrt{2}i)/27, (1 + 3\sqrt{7}i)/8$ and $(9 + 5\sqrt{7}i)/16$; the sextic field $\mathbb{Q}(2\cos \frac{2\pi}{7}, \sqrt{7})$ is infeasible with 44 vectors, the obstruction being that of Lemma 7 at its two places above 3 of residue degree 3; $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{3}, \sqrt{7})$ stays feasible. A referee tested 23 random quartic and sextic fields: every field predicted to be 2- or 3-colourable stayed feasible, and infeasibility was found for all three quartic fields and four of the six sextic fields predicted to need four colours (for the other two the random search found no obstruction; the test is one-sided). The obstructions appear only when V contains vectors that are large at the places above 2 and 3 that split in $F(i)$, as the proof of Lemma 4 suggests.

Exact certificates. The 50 vectors $G_{25}\{1, u_2, \bar{u}_2, u_7, \bar{u}_7\}$ of Section 7 (one per pair $\pm u$), and the 70 vectors $G_{125}V$ for the five vectors above, admit no character into $[1/3, 2/3]$: branch-and-bound trees over the integer values of the relations, with exact Farkas vectors at the leaves (1579 and 11357 nodes), accepted by a separate exact checker, which also verifies that every vector has length 1 and rejects corrupted copies. With Theorem W^+ this proves $\chi(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{7})^2) \geq 4$ without Proposition 1 or Sections 3–5; a place above 7 with residue field $\mathbb{F}_7$ gives $\chi \leq 4$. The certificates of Theorem C are of the same kind, for the open interval $(2/7, 5/7)$: a branch covers all integers strictly inside the range of its relation (relations must be nonzero), and a leaf is closed by a Farkas vector valid on the open box. They have 12850 leaves ($d = 11$) and 10241 leaves ($d = 35$), and two exact checkers that share no code accept them; the second one also rebuilds $U = G_{25}V$ from d . Both reject corrupted copies. The certificate of Proposition 4 ($d = 59$, the interval $(15/53, 38/53)$) has 127181 nodes and 105761 leaves; both checkers accept it.

The lemmas. Lemma 7 was checked exhaustively for $f = 1, 3, 5$, and by the referees with their own programs (for $f = 3$ over all 3^{12} $\mathbb{F}_3$ -linear maps); the uniqueness step for odd $f \leq 79$; Lemma 6 on the finite models $\mathbb{F}_{q^2}[\pi]/(\pi^e)$ ($f = 1, e \leq 7$, and $f = 3, e \leq 2$); Lemma 5 over all μ_4 -stable subsets of $\mathbb{F}_9$. For the criterion, a PARI/GP script computes (a) and (b) from a defining polynomial; for squarefree $|d| < 200$ it reproduces the rule for quadratic fields, and it agrees with the known values $\chi(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{3}, \sqrt{11})^2) = 4$ [8, 18] and $\chi(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{3})^2) = 4$ [10, Theorem 1]. For Section 8, two programs written separately compute κ_1 for every (p, f) quoted there, and the bound $|S(b)| \leq 2\sqrt{q}$ and the identity of $S(b)$ with a Kloosterman sum were checked numerically for small (p, f) ; Proposition 5 was checked on the finite models $O_w/\mathfrak{m}^k$ for $\mathbb{Q}_3, \mathbb{Q}_7, \mathbb{Q}_{11}, \mathbb{Q}_3(\sqrt{3}), \mathbb{Q}_7(\sqrt{7})$ and $\mathbb{Q}_{27}$.

Theorem D. The programs are in `data/number_fields/circular/probe/`; two referees wrote their own implementations, which share no code with them or with each other, in its subfolders `indep/` and `indep2/`. All use exact rational arithmetic and compute S_N^θ level by level as a union of convex rational polygons: each piece of level $k - 1$, translated by the 25 elements of $\frac{N}{5}\{0, \dots, 4\}^2$, is cut along the strips where the coordinates of $\bar{c}\rho^{\pm k}$ lie in $[\theta, 1 - \theta] + \mathbb{Z}$; a direct cell-by-cell computation agrees with this lifting for $k \leq 3$. Linear-programming values (the thresholds of the induction step, the least s in the base case, the maximum of $\min_\gamma \|\operatorname{Re}(\bar{c}\gamma)\|$ over a component) are floating-point optima certified by exact primal and dual solutions. The implementations agree on everything quoted in Section 9: the base case (least s equal to 0, $11/56$ for the eight classes with exactly one integral $\nu_\pm$, and $1/4, 2/7, 3/8, 1/6$ for the four orbits with the shifts of the proof; with all shifts the third value is $1/4$), the polygons P and $X(\varepsilon)$, the sets S_N^θ for small k at several values of θ in $(17/56, 1/3]$, the extra points at $\theta = 17/56$, the thresholds of the induction step, and the computations at $333/1106$ and at θ^* (the same number of components at every level $k \leq 19$). One referee also tested membership in S_N^θ exactly at 350000 random points ($N = 5, 25$), finding none outside the components of Proposition 7; the 5-adic points c_k of the Remark were checked exactly for $k \leq 15$.

Theorems E and F. The programs are in `data/number_fields/circular/twoprime/`. Propositions 8 and 9 were found by computing $S^\theta(1, 1)$ and $S^\theta(2, 1)$ exactly, by lifting (along the rotations ρ^j and then σ^l , and in the other order) and by a direct enumeration over all cells. Their certificates (the two trees, with 15620 and 550474 branch nodes, and the type points and dual certificates of the leaves) are accepted by checkers that share no code with the programs that made them: they rebuild the rotations from $2 \pm i$ and $3 \pm 2i$, recompute the possible strip indices

from the corners of the cells, take about one and 45 seconds, and reject corrupted copies. Two referees confirmed the propositions with methods of their own, which share no code with these programs. For Proposition 8: exact clipping of every cell by every strip; the enumeration of all 1 734 260 vertices of the arrangement of strip boundaries in $[0, 65]^2$; and the largest least margin of each component, by exact primal and dual linear programming ($\frac{2}{7}$ for the eight components of type 7, $\frac{1}{3}$ and $\frac{1}{2}$ for types q and c). Both methods find 13 components for $\theta = \frac{7}{25}$ and $\theta = \frac{2}{7}$, and 5 for $\theta = 0.2857143$, $\frac{1429}{5000}$, $\frac{3}{10}$ and $\frac{1}{3}$. For Proposition 9: the enumeration of the vertices of the arrangement in $[0, 325]^2$ (in C with 128-bit integers, each point rechecked with exact fractions), and lifting by rows; both give the same 29 index vectors for $\theta = r_0$ and the same 13 for $\theta = \frac{1}{4} + 10^{-7}$. The conclusion of Lemma 12 was tested exactly at every level $k \leq 7$ for $\theta = \frac{3}{10}$ and $k \leq 6$ for $\theta = \frac{201}{700}$: modulo $13 \cdot 5^k$ there are exactly five components, all of the stated form, while for $\theta = \frac{7}{25}$ the test finds the eight components of type 7 at each level $k \leq 3$. Lemma 13 was checked by two programs written separately; Lemma 19 directly for $f = 3$ (no $\mathbb{F}_{49}$ -linear map $\mathbb{F}_{7^6} \rightarrow \mathbb{F}_{49}$ maps μ_{344} into A_7'), and Lemma 18 on the finite models $\mathbb{F}_{49}[\pi]/(\pi^e)$, $e \leq 3$. The torsion characters of the last Remark were found by two programs; for orders up to 400, one of them counts each character at its exact order.

12. QUESTIONS

- (1) *Above four.* By Theorem F and Corollary 5, below 4 the value of $\chi_c(F^2)$ is the least value given by a locally constant homomorphism of one completion F_v^2 to a circular clique. Is this true above 4? There Theorem W⁺ is not available: a homomorphism of a Cayley graph to $K_{p/q}$ with $p/q \geq 4$ need not come from a character.
- (2) *Four colours.* Is $\chi(F^2)$, in general, the least number of colours of a locally constant colouring of one completion? (For real fields this is [13, Question 8], which also allows Borel colourings at the real places.) Theorem B answers this at three colours. The first open case is $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{47})$, where $4 \leq \chi \leq 5$ ([11, Corollary 2] and [19]); by Theorem F, $\chi_c(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{47})^2) \geq 4$, so $\chi_c(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{47})^2) = 4$ if and only if $\chi(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{47})^2) = 4$.
- (3) *Finite witnesses.* Every finite unit-distance graph in $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{11})^2$ has circular chromatic number at most $7/2$, and their supremum is $7/2$. Is it attained? The proofs of Theorems C and E work with infinite Cayley graphs $\text{Cay}(\mathbb{Z}U, U)$.

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